Joint Publication 3-18

Joint Forcible Entry Operations

20 October 2025

PREFACE

1. Scope

This publication provides fundamental principles and guidance to plan, execute, and assess joint forcible entry operations.

2. Purpose

This publication has been prepared under the direction of the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff (CJCS). It sets forth joint doctrine to govern the activities and performance of the Armed Forces of the United States in joint operations, and it provides considerations for military interaction with governmental and nongovernmental agencies, multinational forces, and other interorganizational partners. It provides military guidance for the exercise of authority by combatant commanders and other joint force commanders (JFCs) and prescribes joint doctrine for operations and training. It provides military guidance for use by the Armed Forces in preparing and executing their plans and orders. It is not the intent of this publication to restrict the authority of the JFC from organizing the force and executing the mission in a manner the JFC deems most appropriate to ensure unity of effort in the accomplishment of objectives.

3. Application

a. Joint doctrine established in this publication applies to the Joint Staff, combatant commands, subordinate unified commands, joint task forces, subordinate components of these commands, the Services, the National Guard Bureau, and combat support agencies.

b. This doctrine constitutes official advice concerning the enclosed subject matter; however, the judgment of the commander is paramount in all situations.

c. If conflicts arise between the contents of this publication and the contents of Service publications, this publication takes precedence unless the CJCS, normally in coordination with the other members of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, has provided more current and specific guidance, or the Secretary of Defense has directed otherwise. Commanders of forces operating as part of a multinational (alliance or coalition) military command should follow

multinational doctrine and procedures ratified by the United States unless they conflict with this guidance. For doctrine and procedures not ratified by the United States, commanders should evaluate and follow the multinational command's doctrine and procedures, where applicable and consistent with United States law, regulations, and doctrine.

For the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff:



MATTHEW S. STUMPF
Senior Executive Service
Vice Director for Force Development and
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SUMMARY OF CHANGES
REVISION OF JOINT PUBLICATION 3-18
DATED 11 MAY 2017
INCORPORATING CHANGE 1, 9 JANUARY 2018

- **Expands the definition and description of "joint forcible entry operations" beyond seizing territory and holding a lodgment, including description of forcing access into a denied area to enable movement and maneuver to accomplish a mission.**

- **Adds content of five elements of joint forcible entry operations.**

- **Adds a paragraph on integration of forcible entry into joint all-domain operations.**

- **Changes title of Chapter V from "Logistics" to "Sustainment."**

- **Adds Chapter VI, "The Future of Joint Forcible Entry Operations."**

- **Changes title of Appendix B from "Control Joint Forcible Entry Operations" to "Joint Forcible Entry Operations Checklist."**

- **Modifies, adds, and removes terms and definitions from the *Department of Defense Dictionary of Military and Associated Terms.***

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY
COMMANDER'S OVERVIEW

1. Overview

Joint Publication 3-18, *Joint Forcible Entry Operations,* outlines how joint force commanders (JFCs) plan, execute, and assess joint forcible entry operations. The joint force conducts forcible entry operations to seize territory and, if required, to establish a lodgment against armed opposition or to force access into a denied area to enable movement and maneuver to accomplish a mission. The joint force often uses lodgment facilities and infrastructure to receive follow-on forces and logistics. Forcible entry operations occur within a joint operation or campaign. JFCs may direct a forcible entry operation in response to a contingency, at the onset of armed conflict, or in the middle of an ongoing campaign during armed conflict. Forcible entry is inherently an all-domain operation that enables a JFC to expand offensive operations and achieve operational objectives. Forcing access into a denied area enables the joint force to defeat threats to the access and use of portions of the operational area (OA); to control, defeat, disable, and dispose of specific weapons of mass destruction threats; to assist populations and groups; and to conduct other limited-duration missions.

2. Forcible Entry Capabilities

JFCs organize the joint force, using Service or functional components or both, to execute forcible entry operations. The types of forces and combat support agency capabilities required for a forcible entry varies according to the OA and type of operation. The building blocks for a joint forcible entry include amphibious forces (AFs), airborne forces, air assault forces, armored and mechanized forces, special operations forces (SOF), and any combination thereof. The JFC also integrates available capabilities from air, maritime, land, space, and cyberspace forces to achieve forcible entry objectives. The capabilities, employed individually or in combinations, create complementary and reinforcing effects against enemy forces.

a. AFs composed of an amphibious task force and a landing force conducts littoral maneuver by vertical and/or surface means. AFs seek to exploit gaps in the enemy's defenses to secure key objectives associated with establishing a lodgment. In addition to serving as a forcible entry assault force, AFs can conduct follow-on operations from the lodgment and may also be used as follow-on forces. An AF with a forcible entry capability may be forward deployed to quickly initiate or join other forces in a forcible entry operation or as a show of force. Support from the sea and projected ashore facilitates the rapid buildup of combat power, to include the introduction of follow-on forces.

b. Airborne forces can function as the assault force or combine with other capabilities for a forcible entry. As an assault force, airborne forces parachute into an objective area to attack and eliminate armed resistance and secure designated objectives. Airborne forces can also airland into an OA, depending on the JFC mission and enemy disposition. JFCs may employ airborne forces from a lodgment offering the JFC an immediate and

responsive forcible entry capable of deploying directly from the continental United States on short notice without requiring an intermediate staging base (ISB) or re-positioning of sea-based forces.

c. Air assault forces execute forcible entries using tiltrotor and rotary-wing aircraft deployed from land-based facilities and ships. Air assault forces rapidly project combat power throughout the depth of an OA but may require the JFC to establish an ISB. Air assault forces have limited organic fires capability, requiring fire support from the JFC's available capabilities.

d. JFCs can employ armored and mechanized forces to conduct a forcible entry operation. The protected ground mobility and firepower of armored and mechanized forces provide JFCs with a unique capability for forcible entry operations to defeat an enemy's antiaccess/area denial measures, seize a lodgment, and force access into a denied area and during follow-on operations.

e. SOF execute forcible entry operations using any combination of air, land, or sea platforms. SOF may provide special reconnaissance or may attack specific targets. Normally, SOF forcible entry operations are of short duration to meet specific JFC objectives.

3. Elements of Joint Forcible Entry Concept of Operations

The JFC develops a concept of operations (CONOPS) that describes the vision, intent, and operational objectives for a forcible entry operation. The CONOPS addresses how the joint force achieves operational objectives using available resources. It provides flexible options for the JFC to preempt or delay enemy action and impose multiple dilemmas on enemy forces and maximizes the relative advantages for the joint force. The JFC ensures the CONOPS aligns with the combatant commander's campaign plan. The JFC's CONOPS addresses the five elements of forcible entry operations—preparation and deployment, assault, securing the lodgment, introduction of follow-on forces, and transition. Preparation and deployment include mobilizing and deploying forces into an OA, as well as planning and initial operations to set conditions for forcible entry. Assault encompasses actions to seize and hold a lodgment. Securing the lodgment includes actions to protect, organize, and expand it. Introduction of follow-on forces covers the flow of personnel and equipment into the lodgment and their preparation for subsequent operations. During transition, the joint force conducts follow-on operations after a successful forcible entry, continuing the JFC's campaign to defeat enemy forces.

4. Forcible Entry and the Joint Planning Process

The joint force conducts planning for a forcible entry operation during campaign, contingency, or crisis planning. Planners identify the type of plan, time available, and required detail. Campaign and contingency plans vary in scope and level of detail—commander's estimate, base plan, concept plan, and operation plan. During CONOPS development, planners develop flexible options for the JFC that prevent or preempt enemy

action, impose multiple dilemmas on adversary or enemy forces, and create operational advantages for the joint force. Forcible entry operations require extensive joint intelligence preparation of the operational environment (JIPOE). JIPOE supports JFC planning and decision making by identifying, analyzing, and estimating the enemy centers of gravity, critical factors, capabilities, limitations, requirements, vulnerabilities, intentions, and courses of action the entry force is most likely to encounter. Time, distance, physical attributes of the OA, agreement/arrangement with partner nations, or the current situation may dictate the deployment of a joint force to staging areas outside the United States. The JFC may require authorization to conduct advance force operations in the OA to prepare the operational environment (OE) for the introduction of combat forces. Commanders and operational planners may have to compress planning timelines to meet time-sensitive mission requirements.

5. The Future of Joint Forcible Entry Operations

The joint force will face existing and emerging threats in the future OE, including in the information environment and the electromagnetic environment. Rapidly expanding competitive technologies characterize one aspect of the future OE. These technologies may drive the evolution of capabilities in all domains for adversary and friendly forces. This evolution could provide adversaries with capabilities to disrupt mobilizing and deploying joint forces from home station, interrupt critical communications and connectivity across friendly organizations, and disrupt the employment of capabilities within an OA. Additionally, the evolution of threats may force leaders to think beyond the physical aspects of an OE and drive adaptation in fast-paced and dynamic scenarios. With the joint force's rapid integration of advancing technologies into warfighting, and the cost of those technologies becoming more affordable, the future OE could create more transparency. An increase in transparency may shorten the reaction time for the joint force and make engagements more dynamic and volatile.

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CHAPTER I
OVERVIEW OF FORCIBLE ENTRY OPERATIONS

"Today's threats can increasingly synchronize and integrate direct military force and information activities and employ other instruments of national power to create combinations of lethal and nonlethal effects with greater sophistication while less constrained by geographic, functional, legal, or moral boundaries …Long-range antiaccess (A2) capabilities may prevent or inhibit the joint force from entering an operational area (OA). If a force can overcome an enemy's A2 capabilities, additional area denial (AD) capabilities can still limit a force's freedom of action."

Joint Publication 3-0, *Joint Campaigns and Operations*

1. Forcible Entry

a. The joint force conducts forcible entry operations to seize territory and, if required, to establish a lodgment against armed opposition or to force access into a denied area to enable movement and maneuver to accomplish a mission. Forcible entry operations occur within a joint operation or campaign. Joint force commanders (JFCs) may direct a forcible entry operation in response to a contingency, at the onset of armed conflict, or in the middle of an ongoing campaign during armed conflict. Forcible entry is inherently an all-domain operation that enables a JFC to expand offensive operations and achieve operational objectives.

For more information on the competition continuum, see Joint Publication (JP) 3-0, Joint Campaigns and Operations.

b. The joint force seizes and holds lodgments to rapidly build combat power for follow-on operations. A lodgment is a designated area in a hostile or potentially hostile operational area (OA) (e.g., airhead, beachhead, combination thereof) that affords continuous landing of troops and materiel, while providing freedom of maneuver for subsequent operations. The objectives of the operation and campaign dictate the location of the lodgment and the means to seize a lodgment. The joint force often uses lodgment facilities and infrastructure to receive follow-on forces and logistics.

c. The joint force forcibly enters a denied area to accomplish operational objectives. A denied area is an area under enemy or unfriendly control in which friendly forces cannot expect to operate within existing operational restraints and force capabilities. Forcing access into a denied area enables the joint force to achieve various objectives (i.e., defeat threats to the access and use of portions of the OA; control, defeat, disable, and dispose of specific weapons of mass destruction [WMD] threats; assist populations and groups; conduct other missions).

d. Forcible entry may be the initial or supporting effort of a joint operation and campaign to achieve operational and strategic level objectives. The joint force conducts preparatory and follow-on actions to support forcible entry. Using the joint force, the JFC counters enemy antiaccess (A2) and area denial (AD) measures and establishes conditions

for the assault by achieving cyberspace and electromagnetic spectrum (EMS) superiority and local air and maritime supremacy (or superiority if supremacy cannot be attained). Operation POINTBLANK, the United States-British air campaign to weaken German defenses prior to the Normandy landings, is one example of an operation conducted prior to a forcible entry. Once these conditions are met, the JFC initiates the assault. After securing the lodgment and follow-on forces arrive, the joint force transitions to subsequent operations. The Pusan perimeter offensive in September 1950 is an example of a subsequent operation, following a successful forcible entry. Forcible entry is not a stand-alone operation; neglecting integrated planning for preceding and follow-on actions risks undermining campaign success. Focusing solely on the forcible entry operation without fully developing the operations prior to and immediately following it may threaten the JFC's ability to achieve campaign objectives. See Figure I-1.

e. Despite the Service-specific capabilities, techniques, and procedures, forcible entry operations are inherently joint, often requiring resources (e.g., command and control [C2], transportation, sustainment) from all Department of Defense (DoD) components, as well as support from multinational partners and other United States Government departments and agencies.

2. Operational Access by Joint Forcible Entry Operations

a. Operational access, the ability to project military force into an OA with sufficient freedom of action to accomplish the mission, is key to the United States' ability to apply

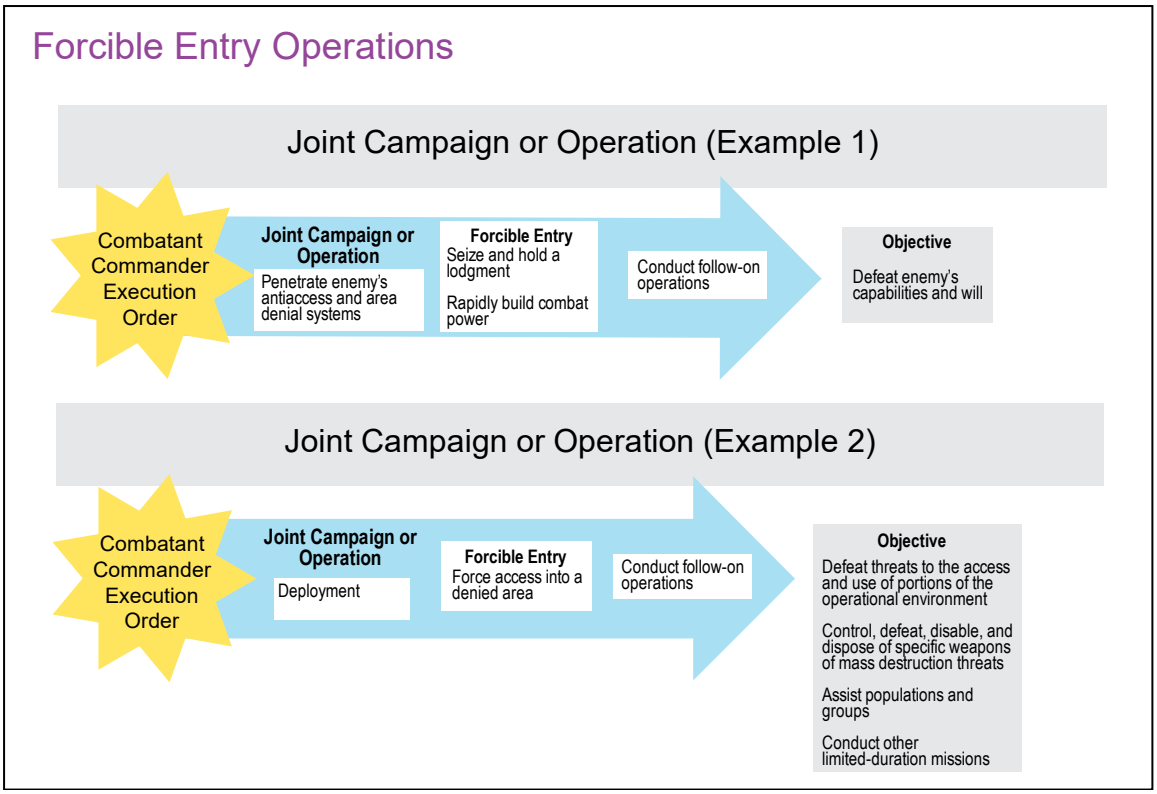


Figure I-1. Forcible Entry Operations

national power. The United States seeks to gain and maintain operational access in strategically important areas worldwide. Operational access facilitates the unhindered national use of select sovereign territory, including areas of the land, air, maritime, space, and cyberspace domains.

b. To credibly deter adversaries, JFCs train, prepare, deploy, and fight for access to geographical areas controlled by adversaries and hostile forces. During armed conflict/war, success requires forcible entry and follow-through. Alerting rapid deployment forces for employment or moving forces toward the OA demonstrates national resolve and intent.

For more information on the strategic uses of military force, see JP 3-0, Joint Campaigns and Operations.

3. Challenges for Forcible Entry

a. The operational environment (OE) and the threats it presents are increasingly complex as JFCs prepare to conduct forcible entry against threats within a combatant commander's (CCDR's) area of responsibility (AOR), with multiple joint operations areas (JOAs), or across multiple combatant command AORs. Uncertainty and ambiguity are inherent aspects of the OE, and JFCs should plan accordingly.

b. During forcible entry operations, the enemy opposes the joint force with various capabilities. Peer enemies present the greatest challenge, contesting access and lodgment with modern equipment and resilient operational formations. The enemy may possess WMD, using them or threatening their use to deter forcible entry.

c. Enemy forces can contest the joint force across all domains at extended ranges with increased lethality. The enemy can employ long-range fires, integrated air defense, and a global network of reconnaissance and surveillance capabilities to hinder the approach of the joint force. A formidable enemy can establish local land, air, and maritime superiority, while improved space and cyberspace capabilities enhance its reconnaissance and surveillance and counter joint force operations. The enemy can attack the joint force from the homeland to the OA, massing forces to defend key terrain and counter joint force movements. During airborne and air assaults, the enemy's integrated air defense systems positioned along air corridors/routes and near lodgments can destroy forces en route to or landing at a lodgment. During amphibious assaults, the enemy's air and maritime capabilities can destroy forces approaching a lodgment from sea.

d. The joint force faces increased threats from an enemy's long-range fires and unmanned systems across the air, land, and maritime domains. The enemy can leverage low-cost technology to field large quantities of unmanned aircraft systems, including loitering munitions and surface and subsurface drones. These systems provide real-time surveillance, C2, or payloads to attack the joint force, which can disrupt the assault forces en route to or within the OA.

e. Information and communication technology advances enable adversaries and enemies to influence the global audience against joint forcible entry operations. They may portray the joint force as the aggressor, urging intervention by the United Nations or other

global organizations. These messages may influence surrogate and proxy forces to conduct operations against the joint force.

f. Enemy operational formations create strategic depth that can disrupt joint force deployment to a region, counter forcible entry, or prevent follow-on operations. The scale and capability of these formations may require the joint force to dedicate significant time to attrit enemy forces posing the greatest threat to the lodgment.

g. The enemy may use WMD against the joint force. The enemy may perceive a forcible entry operation as a risk to their nation's survival if the enemy force is unable to deny or defeat the joint force at the lodgment area. This perception may cause the enemy's leaders to employ a WMD to stop the joint force's advance. Potential targets for the attack include the lodgment areas and intermediate staging bases (ISBs).

For more information on WMD and countering WMD, see JP 3-40, Joint Countering Weapons of Mass Destruction.

4. Fundamentals of Forcible Entry Operations

To set favorable conditions for operational success, the following fundamentals apply for forcible entry operations:

a. **Achieve Surprise.** Planners should strive to achieve surprise regarding exact objectives, times, methods, and forces employed in forcible entry operations. The degree of surprise required depends on the nature of the operation. Achieving surprise usually depends on multiple factors including operations in the information environment (OIE), military deception (MILDEC), and operational tempo. Surprise is not necessary for operational success (particularly when the joint force has overwhelming superiority), but it can significantly reduce operational risk.

For more information on planning, see JP 5-0, Joint Planning.

b. **Visualize the OE.** The joint intelligence preparation of the operational environment (JIPOE) process provides the JFC with a holistic understanding of conditions, circumstances, and influences within the OE that support JFC decision making.

For more information on JIPOE, see JP 2-0, Joint Intelligence, and the Joint Guide for Joint Intelligence Preparation of the Operational Environment. *For more information on geospatial engineering, see JP 3-34,* Joint Engineering Operations.

c. **Isolate the Lodgment.** The joint force defeats or destroys any enemy air, maritime, and land capabilities with the potential to prevent or affect the establishment of the lodgment. The destruction or defeat of enemy forces facilitates securing airheads, beachheads, and points of penetration. At a minimum, the joint force establishes local air, maritime, land, and EMS superiority over the lodgment area and within the OA. Local superiority enables the joint force to isolate areas, protect friendly forces, and maintain lines of communications (LOCs) to lodgment areas. The joint force maintains isolation of the lodgment throughout the operation to prevent or disrupt enemy reinforcement, reconstitution, and repositioning of capabilities.

Failure to isolate the lodgment can hamper or stall momentum. In the event of culmination prior to isolation, the JFC plans a branch plan for the alternate penetration or retrograde.

d. **Secure the Lodgment.** The joint force assaults a lodgment from the air, maritime, and land domains to secure key objectives. The objectives include airheads, beachheads, or a combination of both to facilitate the continuous landing of forces and materiel. Controlling the tempo of the forcible entry operation is critical to success. The joint force capitalizes on surprise, violence, and overwhelming force to secure objectives, destroy enemy forces in the lodgment, and prevent or delay the reaction of enemy forces located outside of the lodgment. After securing objectives, assault forces prepare to defend against enemy attacks.

e. **Expand the Lodgment.** The joint force quickly builds combat power to enhance security and the ability to respond to enemy counter attacks, enable continuous landing of troops and materiel, and facilitate transition to subsequent operations. Failure to expand the lodgment can severely hamper or stall the momentum of the overall operation.

OPERATION OVERLORD—FRANCE, 1944

The D-Day invasion on 6 June 1944 was preceded by counterintelligence, military deception (MILDEC), and operations security efforts unprecedented in scope. As early as 1940, the British initiated actions to sink or capture the German weather ships and submarines stationed in the North Atlantic. This continued throughout the war. German agents operating in Great Britain were eliminated or "turned," and almost all of the intelligence they sent to Germany was compromised. Prior to the invasion, Allied bombers struck targets throughout the possible invasion areas, while avoiding undue concentration on the Normandy Peninsula. Allied air forces denied the German Air Force any aerial reconnaissance over the assembly areas and ports used for the invasion. Entire English civilian communities were removed from staging and embarkation areas and the invasion troops themselves kept in isolation. An elaborate MILDEC operation maintained the ruse that the main invasion would strike the Pas de Calais area instead of Normandy. On the night of the invasion, false parachute drops were staged in areas outside of the invasion area.

The effect on German defensive operations was critical. At the strategic level, the Germans expected the invasion in the spring of 1944. Lack of operational intelligence forced the Germans to defend all the possible invasion areas in western France, and kept most mobile reserves away from the invasion beaches in a central location. Allied air and French partisans delayed them from striking the lodgment until too late. The lack of accurate weather data led to erroneous weather forecasts for early June. Lacking air reconnaissance, the Germans kept powerful forces to defend the Pas de Calais, which the German Army assessed as most likely and most dangerous area.

Operation Overlord D-Day
Anthony Hall, 2003

f. **Identify Needed Infrastructure and Limit Damage.** During planning, JFCs identify enemy infrastructure for potential future use by friendly forces. Limiting physical damage lessens the time needed to rebuild. Planners should identify critical infrastructure that is not a valid target for achieving the JFC's objectives and place it on the JFC's no-strike list early in the planning process.

For more information on no strike lists, see JP 3-60, Joint Targeting.

g. **Manage the Impact of Obstacles and Environmental Factors.** Managing the impact of environmental factors and obstacles refers to overcoming the effect of land and sea obstacles and determining the impact of climate, weather, and other naturally occurring hazards. The JFC should take advantage of environmental conditions that present an operational advantage to the joint force or a disadvantage to enemy forces to optimize mission effectiveness. This may also aid in minimization of natural obstacles encountered in the assault or follow-on operations.

h. **Counter WMD and Operate in Chemical, Biological, Radiological, or Nuclear (CBRN) Environments.** The joint force should anticipate, prevent, detect, and mitigate enemy use of WMD and CBRN threats. The enemy may employ WMD to attack or threaten the joint force, influence joint force decision making, or channel friendly forces. Chemical hazards, such as toxic industrial materials, may be leveraged or emplaced by enemy forces as part of their defenses.

i. **Integrate Enabling Capabilities.** Intelligence operations, surveillance and reconnaissance operations, civil-military operations (CMO), and special operations are key to setting the conditions for forcible entry operational success. JFCs integrate these capabilities into the operation at every stage from initial planning to transition.

OPERATION CHROMITE—KOREA, 1950

On 15 September 1950, 83 days after North Korea invaded South Korea, a joint command of the United States, Joint Task Force (JTF) 7, initiated Operation CHROMITE by conducting an amphibious assault on the port of Inchon on Korea's west coast.

Operation CHROMITE took place on the heels of the retreat of the United States and Republic of Korea forces down the Korean Peninsula in June and July to an enclave on the peninsula's southern tip. The primary objectives were to land a large force behind the bulk of the North Korean People's Army (NKPA), recapture South Korea's capital, Seoul, cut NKPA logistic lines, and provide an "anvil" against which the US Eighth Army, attacking from the south, would crush the NKPA.

JTF 7 commenced operations at 0630 on 15 September with an assault against the critical island of Wolmi-Do following massive bombardment. By 1800 on 16 September, main landings on Inchon had secured a beachhead.

The Korean War
Brian Catchpole, 2001

5. Forcible Entry Capabilities

JFCs organize the joint force, using Service or functional components or both, to execute forcible entry operations. The types of forces and combat support agency capabilities required for a forcible entry varies according to the OA and type of operation. The building blocks for a joint forcible entry include **amphibious forces (AFs), airborne forces, air assault forces, armored and mechanized forces, special operations forces (SOF), and any combination thereof**. The JFC also integrates available capabilities from air, maritime, land, space, and cyberspace forces to achieve forcible entry objectives. These capabilities, employed individually or in combinations, create complementary and reinforcing effects against enemy forces.

a. **AFs.** An AF, composed of an amphibious task force (ATF) and a landing force (LF), together with other forces that are trained, organized, and equipped for amphibious operations, conducts littoral maneuver by vertical or surface means. AFs seek to exploit gaps in the enemy's defenses to secure key objectives associated with establishing a lodgment. In addition to serving as a forcible entry assault force, these forces can conduct follow-on operations from the lodgment. The JFCs may insert the AF as a follow-on force. An AF with a forcible entry capability may be forward-deployed to quickly initiate or join other forces in a forcible entry operation or as a show of force. Support from the sea and projected ashore facilitates the rapid buildup of combat power, to include the introduction of follow-on forces.

(1) AFs leverage organic capabilities, including air and fire support, logistics, and mobility, to access areas by forcible entry. An amphibious assault requires the rapid deployment of sufficient combat power ashore to seize AF objectives. The assault begins on order, when sufficient AF elements for ship-to-shore movement arrive in the OA and ends when the AF meets the conditions specified in the initiating directive.

(2) JFCs employ amphibious assaults to initiate campaigns or joint operations, like the 1942 landing on Guadalcanal. Allied commanders supported the campaign to neutralize Rabaul in the Southwest Pacific and the 1944 Normandy landings that established a beachhead for the Allied campaign in Western Europe. Factors influencing amphibious assault selection as the type of forcible entry operation include mobility, task-organization flexibility, the ability to rapidly build combat power ashore, and sustainability. These operations can exploit surprise, target enemy weakness, and project combat power at the most advantageous location and time. The threat of an amphibious assault can induce enemies to divert resources, establish or reinforce defensive positions, or disperse forces. JFCs may employ amphibious assaults to secure key terrain to permit or deny access to adjacent waters.

For more information on amphibious assaults, see JP 3-02, Amphibious Operations.

INCHON AMPHIBIOUS ASSAULT

The Inchon amphibious assault (see Operation CHROMITE) established a lodgment on the west coast of Korea, simultaneously with the counteroffensive to break out of the Pusan Perimeter. The Pusan offensive involved the majority of United Nations ground forces. The amphibious force and forces from the Pusan area linked up in the vicinity of Seoul to continue the offensive.

South to the Naktong, North to the Yalu
Roy E. Appleman

b. **Airborne Forces.** Airborne forces can function as the assault force or combine with other capabilities for a forcible entry. As an assault force, airborne forces parachute into an objective area to attack and eliminate armed resistance and secure designated objectives. Airborne forces can airland into an OA, depending on the JFC mission and enemy disposition. JFCs may employ airborne forces from a lodgment. Airborne forces offer the JFC an immediate and responsive forcible entry option capability, able to be launched directly from the continental United States on short notice without requiring an ISB or re-positioning of sea-based forces.

c. **Air Assault Forces.** Air assault forces execute forcible entries using tiltrotor and rotary-wing aircraft deployed from land-based facilities and ships. Air assault forces rapidly project combat power throughout the depth of an OA but may require the JFC to establish an ISB. Air assault forces have limited organic fires capability, requiring fire support from the JFC's available capabilities.

Appendix A, "Airborne and Air Assault Operations," provides more specifics on airborne and air assault operations.

d. **Armored and Mechanized Forces.** JFCs can employ armored and mechanized forces to conduct a forcible entry operation. The protected ground mobility and firepower of armored and mechanized forces provide JFCs with a unique capability for forcible entry operations to defeat an enemy's A2/AD measures, seize a lodgment, force access into a denied area, and employ these forces during follow-on operations.

For more information on land operations, see JP 3-31, Joint Land Operations.

e. **SOF.** SOF execute forcible entry operations using any combination of air, land, or sea platforms. SOF may provide special reconnaissance or may attack specific targets. Normally, SOF forcible entry operations are shorter-duration activities characterized by the use of agile and discreet forces that are precisely tailored to meet specific JFC objectives in denied or diplomatically sensitive environments.

For more information on SOF missions and capabilities, refer to JP 3-05, Joint Doctrine for Special Operations.

6. Elements of a Joint Forcible Entry Concept of Operations

a. The JFC develops a concept of operations (CONOPS) that describes the vision, intent, and operational objectives for a forcible entry operation. The CONOPS addresses how the joint force achieves operational objectives using available resources. It provides flexible options for the JFC to preempt or delay enemy action, impose multiple dilemmas on enemy forces, and maximize the relative advantages for the joint force. The JFC ensures the CONOPS aligns with the CCDR's campaign plan.

b. The JFC's CONOPS addresses the five elements of forcible entry operations—preparation and deployment, assault, securing the lodgment, introduction of follow-on forces, and transition. Preparation and deployment include mobilizing and deploying forces into an OA, as well as planning and initial operations to set conditions for forcible entry. Assault encompasses actions to seize and hold a lodgment. Securing the lodgment includes actions to protect, organize, and expand it. Introduction of follow-on forces covers the flow of personnel and equipment into the lodgment and their preparation for subsequent operations. During transition, the joint force conducts follow-on operations after a successful forcible entry, continuing the JFC's campaign to defeat enemy forces. Chapter IV, "Operations," expands on the elements of forcible entry operations.

c. During CONOPS development, planners account for complementary and reinforcing capabilities during a forcible entry. Combining amphibious, airborne, air assault, armored and mechanized, and special operations forces, along with supporting effects in space, cyberspace and the EMS, creates multiple dilemmas for an enemy force. The enemy's reaction, or lack thereof, to any of the capabilities may create exploitable advantages for the joint force.

For more information on CONOPS development, see JP 5-0, Joint Planning.

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CHAPTER II
COMMAND AND CONTROL

". . . a superior command system may serve as a force multiplier and compensate for weaknesses . . . such as numerical inferiority or the politically induced need to leave the initiative to the enemy."

Martin van Creveld
***Command in War*, 1985**

1. Purpose

This chapter provides guidance on employment options, organization of the forcible entry's OA, command relationships, major C2 functions, rules of engagement (ROE), and friendly fire mitigation that support joint forcible entry operations.

2. Force Employment

The JFC determines the specific forcible entry capability or combination of capabilities to achieve the mission. Unity of command is vital when combining amphibious, airborne, air assault, armored and mechanized, and special operations forces. Due to its complexity, commanders should keep forcible entry execution as simple as possible. All elements of the joint force and supporting commands should understand the commander's intent, CONOPS, scheme of maneuver, and coordination requirements.

a. The JFC determines the capabilities required to seize a lodgment and decides whether to conduct the forcible entry as a concurrent or integrated operation. **Concurrent forcible entry operations** occur when a commander conducts a combination of amphibious raid or assault, airborne assault, air assault, ground assault, and special operations simultaneously but as distinct operations with separate OAs and objectives. During concurrent operations, these entry forces are not mutually supporting. Operation NORTHERN DELAY (2003), the airborne operation into Bashur, Iraq, supporting Operation IRAQI FREEDOM, is a historical example of a concurrent forcible entry operation. **Integrated forcible entry operations** result when the commander simultaneously conducts an amphibious assault, airborne assault, air assault, armored and mechanized assault, and special operation within the same OA, with mutually supporting objectives. For example, Operation OVERLORD, in Normandy (1944), demonstrated an integrated forcible entry when the airborne assault supported amphibious landings.

b. **The distinction between concurrent and integrated operations** has implications for organizing forces, establishing command relationships, and applying force to accomplish the mission. Factors that may impact the establishing authority's decision include:

(1) The responsibility for the preponderance of the mission.

(2) Time, phase, and duration of the operation.

(3) Friendly force capabilities.

(4) Threat capabilities.

(5) C2 capabilities.

(6) Conditions of the OE.

(7) Recommendations from subordinate commanders.

(8) Follow-on missions, anticipated operations, or transition considerations based upon the objective(s) of the overall operation or larger campaign plan.

(9) The diplomatic environment.

3. Organization of the Forcible Entry Operational Area

a. **Organizing OAs**. CCDRs and other JFCs temporarily designate smaller OAs (e.g., JOA, area of operations [AO]). The JFC specifies authorities and responsibilities within an OA. The extent of an OA and types of forces employed depend on the scope and nature of the mission. Each OA is based on an associated area(s) of influence, which is unique to the organic capabilities of every commander and the forces under their C2.

For more information on organizing OAs, areas of interest, and areas of influence, see JP 3-0, Joint Campaigns and Operations.

b. **Maintaining OA Access.** JFCs establish and maintain access to provide a forward presence; establish and maintain forward (intermediate) basing (to include availability of airfields); demonstrate freedom of navigation; and conduct military engagement, security cooperation, and deterrence operations. This effort may involve maintenance of intertheater air and sea LOCs.

c. **JOA.** A JOA is an area of land, sea, airspace, and cyberspace defined by a CCDR or subordinate unified commander, in which a JFC (normally a commander, joint task force [JTF]) conducts military operations to accomplish a specific mission. JOAs are particularly useful when operations have a limited scope and geographic area, cross the boundaries of AORs, or cover geography between two theaters. During a forcible entry operation, JFCs may conduct operations within one or more JOAs.

d. **Amphibious Objective Area (AOA).** The JFC or joint force maritime component commander (JFMCC) normally establishes an AOA for amphibious operations. The AOA is a geographical area of sufficient size for the AF's execution of sea, air, and land operations to secure objectives. The initiating directive normally specifies the AOA. This area should be of sufficient size to ensure accomplishment of the AF's mission but not be too large for the commander, ATF to defend. The AOA is three dimensional including the waters below and the airspace above.

For more information on AOAs, see JP 3-02, Amphibious Operations.

e. **AO.** JFCs may define AOs for the joint force. AOs do not typically encompass the entire OA but should be large enough for component commanders to accomplish their missions (to include a designated amount of airspace) and protect their forces. Component commanders with AOs typically designate subordinate AOs within which their subordinate forces operate. These commanders employ the full range of joint and Service control measures and graphics as coordinated with other component commanders and their representatives to delineate responsibilities, deconflict operations, and achieve unity of effort.

f. **Joint Special Operations Area (JSOA).** A JSOA is an area of land, sea, and airspace assigned by a JFC to the commander of a joint special operations task force (TF) for conducting special operations activities. The JFC may establish a JSOA to delineate and facilitate simultaneous conventional and special operations, provide a control measure, and assist in avoiding friendly fire incidents. The joint special operations TF commander may request the establishment of a JSOA. Within a JSOA, the special operations commander may further assign specific areas or sectors to subordinate commanders for mission execution. The scope and duration of the special operations mission, OE, and diplomatic considerations all influence the number, composition, and sequencing of SOF and supporting forces deployed into a JSOA. The JFC may limit the composition of the JSOA to accommodate a discrete, direct-action mission or expand it to enable a continuing broad range of unconventional warfare operations.

g. **Airspace Control Area.** The airspace control area for the forcible entry operation is that airspace defined by the boundaries that delineate the OA and may include sub-areas. This airspace may entail any OA and is a means of planning and dividing responsibility. While an OA is in existence, airspace control within the OA is in accordance with JFC guidance, the airspace control plan, and airspace control order.

h. **Control and Coordination Measures.** Control and coordination of forcible entry operations pose a particularly difficult challenge to all elements of the joint force. In addressing this challenge, the JFCs and appropriate commanders may employ various control and coordination measures that facilitate the execution of operations and, at the same time, protect the force to the greatest possible degree. The types of measures include maneuver control measures, such as boundaries that circumscribe OAs; control measures to facilitate joint force maneuver; and fire support coordination measures, including both permissive measures to facilitate attacks on targets and restrictive measures to safeguard forces and airspace coordinating measures, such as the airspace control subarea/sector, a subdivision of the larger airspace control area.

For guidance on organizing the OA, see JP 3-0, Joint Campaign and Operations, *for guidance on organizing the air space, see JP 3-52,* Joint Airspace Control.

4. Command Relationships for Forcible Entry Operations

a. **JFC Authority.** JFCs have authority to assign missions, redirect efforts, and direct coordination among subordinate commanders. JFCs should enable Service tactical and operational groupings to function in line with their organization and training.

b. **CCDRs.** CCDRs may organize the forcible entry force as a subordinate JTF or designate an existing Service component commander to conduct forcible entry operations. An initiating directive provides guidance on command relationships and other pertinent instructions for the duration of the forcible entry operation.

c. **Subordinate JTF Commanders.** Like the CCDR's actions, a JTF commander may establish an additional subordinate JTF for the forcible entry operation or organize the forcible entry around an existing component. The JTF, established by the CCDR, can serve as the JFC for the overall campaign or joint operation, while the additional subordinate JTF or existing component can focus solely on the forcible entry operation.

For more information on JFCs and command relationships, see JP 3-33, Joint Force Headquarters*, and JP 1, Volume 2,* The Joint Force.

d. **Functional Component Commanders.** The multiple complex tasks confronting the JFC may challenge the JFC's span of control and ability to oversee and influence each task. Designating a joint force functional component commander for a particular functional area enables resolution of joint issues at the functional component level and enhances component interaction at that level. Delegating control of the forcible entry operation to a functional component commander will permit the JFC to focus on other responsibilities in the OA. If organized under functional lines, the following information is relevant:

(1) **Joint Force Land Component Commander (JFLCC).** The JFLCC's overall roles and responsibilities are to plan, coordinate, and employ designated forces for joint land operations in support of the JFC's CONOPS. The JFLCC normally commands forcible entry operations that involve airborne, air assault, and armored and mechanized forces. The JFLCC typically designates the commander, airborne, or air assault force. For operations that involve a combination of land and amphibious forces, the JFC determines the appropriate command relationship between the land and maritime component commanders.

For more information on support and supporting command relationships, see JP 1, Volume 2, The Joint Force.

(2) **JFMCC.** The JFMCC's overall roles and responsibilities are to plan, coordinate, and employ designated forces for joint maritime operations in support of the JFC's CONOPS. The JFMCC should integrate all naval warfare areas such as strike, undersea warfare, and surface warfare, while coordinating the joint capabilities to support amphibious operations.

(3) **Joint Force Air Component Commander.** The joint force air component commander's overall roles and responsibilities are to plan, coordinate, synchronize, and integrate the actions of assigned, attached, and supporting air forces in time, space, and purpose in support of the JFC's CONOPS. The joint force air component commander closely coordinates with the supported functional component commander or JTF commander to establish airspace control plans and area air defense plans in support of the forcible entry operation as discussed below.

(4) **Joint Force Special Operations Component Commander.** The joint force special operations component commander provides recommendations to the JFC on the employment of assigned or attached SOF, including planning and coordinating special operations or accomplishing such operational missions as assigned. The joint force special operations component commander supports the JFC with SOF components to support the JTF. If designated, the joint force special operations component commander provides a process for synchronizing SOF and conventional forces with the JTF through the JFLCC.

(5) **Joint Force Space Component Commander.** The joint force space component commander is responsible for integrating, synchronizing, and coordinating effects in space with JFC operations. This includes exercising C2 over assigned and attached space forces and ensuring operations in, from, or to the United States Space Command AOR are coordinated with United States Space Command.

e. **ATF and LF Commanders.** The JFC may retain operational control over the Service or functional component commands executing the amphibious operation or delegate operational control or tactical control of the AF. Similarly, the JFC may remain the common superior to the commander, ATF, and the commander, LF, or delegate this responsibility to a subordinate commander who is neither the commander, ATF, nor the commander, LF. The JFC organizes the AF in such a way as to best accomplish the mission based on the CONOPS. An establishing directive is essential to ensure unity of effort within the AF. The JFC or establishing authority typically establishes the support relationship between the commander, ATF, and commander, LF.

For additional information on C2 by functional component commanders, see JP 3-30, Joint Air Operations; *JP 3-31,* Joint Land Operations; *and JP 3-32,* Joint Maritime Operations. *For further details on amphibious command relationships, see JP 3-02,* Amphibious Operations, *and JP 3-52,* Joint Airspace Control, *for guidance on organizing the air space.*

f. **Airborne TF Commander.** If an airborne assault is part of the forcible entry operation, airlift forces from either the continental United States, an ISB, or a theater airbase deliver the airborne force. The airborne TF commander normally organizes the parachute assault force, airlift force, and follow-on airland forces to best accomplish the mission based on the CONOPS. The command relationships established among the commander, airborne TF; the commander, airlift force; the joint force air component commander; and other designated commanders of the forcible entry force are an important decision. An establishing JFC directive is essential to ensure unity of effort within and for the support of the airborne assault force. The airborne TF commander normally exercises responsibility for the airlift plan, to include priority of airdrop and airland sorties, the preparatory fires plan, and the ground tactical plan in the airhead. The airborne TF commander's responsibilities end upon achievement of a secure airhead line and the establishment of either a JFLCC or designated ground commander command post in the airhead.

g. **Forcible Entry Employing a Combination of Forces.** The JFC, Service component commander, or functional component commander may command forcible entry operations combining airborne, air assault, armored and mechanized, and special

operations forces, to include multinational forces. Following a successful forcible entry, the JFC may adjust command relationships to align with the operational plan.

5. Airspace Control

Airspace control is the exercise of delegated authority over designated airspace and users through control procedures and coordination measures to maximize operational effectiveness in support of JFC operational objectives. C2 of airspace requires two key elements, a control authority and a control system.

For further details on airspace control, refer to JP 3-52, Joint Airspace Control.

a. **Airspace Control Authority (ACA).** The JFC normally designates an ACA who establishes and operates the airspace control system (ACS). The ACA monitors, assesses, and controls OA airspace, directing changes to align with the JFC's intent.

(1) **Airspace Control During Amphibious Operations.** JP 3-02, *Amphibious Operations,* and JP 3-52, *Joint Airspace Control,* provide detailed discussions on airspace control during amphibious assault operations.

(2) **Airspace Control During Land Operations.** When an airborne or air assault force is the supported entry force in a forcible entry operation, the ACA may use airborne C2 assets to enhance coordination and control of joint air operations and airspace control, improving real-time communication between land and air elements and helping to deconflict fires, maneuver, and airspace use during entry and initial lodgment establishment.

(a) The distances or duration of airborne and air assault operations may require the joint force to establish special air traffic control facilities or special tactics teams to extend control into the objective area.

(b) The volume of air traffic throughout the airhead demands careful coordination to limit potential conflict and to enable the success of mission-essential operations within the airhead. The commander may request to establish a high-density airspace control zone when planned operations involve a concentrated and complex mix of airspace users and weapons supporting a ground operation. If the maneuver commander has an airspace control element, it normally controls access to the high-density airspace control zone. The ground force commander can nominate a high-density airspace control zone which should, at a minimum, include the airspace bounded by the airhead line. All aircraft flights within a high-density airspace control zone should coordinate with the drop zone, landing zone (LZ), and the agency responsible for controlling the joint airspace. The air mission commander coordinates with the assault force commander to select the time on target and the direction of approach into and through the airhead.

b. **ACS.** The forces involved in the operation largely determine the choices available to the ACA in designating an ACS to control joint air operations; system interoperability is also a major determining factor. For the ACS to function effectively, the ACA must maximize and enhance the capabilities of the collective force using existing control systems.

(1) **ACS During Amphibious Operations.** The ACS during amphibious operations is discussed in detail in JP 3-02, *Amphibious Operations.*

(2) **ACS During Land Operations.** The ACA normally controls the airspace through the theater air control system and the Army air-ground system. Certain situations might restrict ground-based system use, requiring airborne or sea-based systems for airspace control. Commanders and staff should closely monitor and plan critical communications nodes employment within the theater air control system and the Army air-ground system. JP 3-52, *Joint Airspace Control*, provides guidance on the ACS during land operations.

6. Air Defense Command and Control

Commanders should protect the AO, including ingress and egress routes, with an integrated air defense system that combines air, land, maritime, and space assets supported by cyberspace capabilities. During the early stages of a forcible entry, enemy aircraft and surface-to-surface missiles pose significant threats to the joint force. Air and missile defense operations assist in gaining air superiority and protecting the assault force. The area air defense commander (AADC) coordinates joint air defense by integrating all surface-to-air and air-to-air assets into the air defense plan and ensuring compliance with JFC-approved procedures and weapons control measures.

a. **Air Defense C2 During Amphibious Assault.** The AADC is responsible for joint force defensive counterair. In amphibious operations, the AADC may divide the airspace into regions or sectors with regional or sector air defense commanders to enhance the decentralized defensive counterair execution.

For further details on air defense during amphibious operations, refer to JP 3-02, Amphibious Operations. *For further details on maritime air defense C2, refer to JP 3-32,* Joint Maritime Operations.

b. **Air Defense C2 During Land Operations**

(1) During air movement to the OA, the AADC normally controls air defense operations from an airborne platform (e.g., Airborne Warning and Control System). In practice, extended distances from staging bases to designated OAs may require the AADC to delegate control responsibilities to an air control element on board the airborne platform. Fighter aircraft alone may constitute the initial air defense assets available to the commander, who controls these aircraft through established procedural controls.

(2) Commanders ensure forces initially entering the AO possess organic, short-range air defense systems, to include counter-unmanned aircraft systems (C-UASs), and integrate those systems into the air defense C2 architecture. The AADC may establish and plan procedural control measures and guidelines to expedite integration of assets.

(3) With force buildup and the introduction of follow-on forces into the lodgment area, more robust, high- to medium-altitude air defense systems likely become available.

The forces with these systems establish communications with the AADC's C2 agency to incorporate their systems into the established air defense system.

(4) Once established, designated AADC control and reporting centers normally assume air defense control responsibilities for forces external to an established AOA or AO as defined by the JFC or the initiating directive.

(5) Specific implications for naval forces supporting commander, airborne/air assault force:

(a) Participating naval aircraft conduct operations under the control of the appropriate C2 agency.

(b) Since some participating ships have limited organic naval air defense systems aboard, the AADC should take measures to protect a supporting AF by other means.

For more information on planning and executing air defense during amphibious operations and land operations, see JP 3-01, Countering Air and Missile Threats.

7. Communications

Communications systems supporting forcible entry operations should be interoperable, adaptable, and trusted**.** The forcible entry force achieves interoperability through commonality, compatibility, standardization, and liaison. National caveats and policies for each nation dictate the level of sharing and interoperability between United States (US) and multinational forces. To support agile forces and operational concepts, the communications architecture should be adaptable to a wide range of missions without the need for reconfiguration. Agile connectivity and effective data exchange should incorporate Internet protocol integration when possible. Sharing enables the mutual use of information services or capabilities between entities in the OA. Typical forcible entry operations communications employ satellite communications and single-channel ultrahigh frequency, very high frequency, and high frequency radios. The joint force should assume the enemy will degrade or disrupt friendly communications and plan accordingly. The communications system directorate of a joint staff is responsible for providing input to orders and plans and for coordinating communications system support and services during operations.

For more information on satellite communications and single channel frequency radios, see Army Techniques Publication 6-02.72/Marine Corps Reference Publication 3-30B.3/Navy Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 6-02.2/Air Force Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 3-12, Multi-Service Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures for Tactical Radios.

a. **Communications System Planning.** Once the JFC establishes the specific C2 organization for the forcible entry operation, and identifies the information exchange requirements, communications system planning begins. Communications system planning is an integral part of joint force planning. The communications system directorate of a joint staff plans and establishes the communications system and the communications

estimate of supportability during course of action (COA) development and selection under the joint planning process (JPP). The communications system directorate of a joint staff conducts communications system planning in close coordination with the intelligence directorate of a joint staff (J-2) to identify specialized equipment and dissemination requirements for some types of information. Because communications systems are built-up at the objective area, some aspects of communications support are unique in forcible entry operations.

For more information on communications system planning, see JP 6-0, Joint Communications.

b. **Communications Support for AF Operations**. Communications planners should refer to JP 3-02, *Amphibious Operations,* and appropriate Service doctrine and tactics, techniques, and procedures as guides for determining fundamental principles, considerations, and best practices related to communications support.

c. **Communications Support for Land Operations.** Communications requirements vary with the mission, scale, composition, geography, and location of the joint force and the senior headquarters. Land forces use the existing theater communications systems established and managed by the CCDR. They may supplement the available theater communications systems with nonstandard commercial systems to meet the operational needs of a forcible entry operation. Significant considerations for airborne and air assault operations include the use of ISBs and airborne C2 platforms, to include en route mission planning and intelligence sharing, which can add to the complexity of managing the communications architecture. Airborne/air assault forces initially deploy with a limited communications capability, largely based on ultrahigh frequency satellite communications. Communications support becomes more robust as signal units and equipment enter the OA via airdrop or are airlanded into the airhead.

(1) All elements of the forcible entry force should resolve C2 relationships, nets, frequency assignments, codes, navigational aids, and any other communications issues before the initial assault begins. Commanders use rehearsals as an opportunity to identify and resolve potential communication issues.

(2) Long-range radio communications may be necessary with US-based forces or ISBs to facilitate control of personnel, supplies, and equipment into the airhead or lodgment. The higher headquarters establishes long-range communications with the lower headquarters. The primary means of long-range communications is satellite based. The higher headquarters may be on land, sea, or air and may maintain contact through retransmission and relay sites. The communications plan establishes interoperability with the overall joint force communications architecture and provides redundancy for the force to adequately C2 operations.

(3) Ground commanders in airlift aircraft may communicate with the chain of command over the Army secure en route communications package. Normally, the airlift mission commander and the airborne TF commander are in the same aircraft. The senior ground commander can advise embarked ground commanders of changes in the ground tactical situation or to the air movement plan.

(4) Airborne/air assault forcible entry operations require the use of redundant airborne and ground command posts. Normally, a joint force airborne command post operates from a joint airborne communications center, while the airborne/air assault force's command post operates from a fixed-wing platform with required communications installed or a specially configured C2 rotary-wing or tiltrotor aircraft.

(5) Assault forces can use tactical satellite downlink and other beyond line-of-sight communications systems to communicate with United States Air Force special tactics teams, air mobility liaison officers, and contingency response forces in objective areas. The use of special navigational aids and homing devices to direct aircraft to specified areas (e.g., a designated drop zone) may be necessary. Specialized airborne/air assault force personnel (e.g., special tactics teams, reconnaissance and surveillance forces) possess navigational aids, Global Positioning System, and homing devices. These teams deploy early to guide the airborne/air assault forces and provide reconnaissance, surveillance, visual flight rules service, and limited instrument flight rules air traffic control service. Other joint forces, such as SOF, Army Rangers, or Marine force reconnaissance elements, are capable of performing these functions.

8. Rules of Engagement

All forces operate under the standing ROE. CCDRs typically develop theater-specific ROE approved by the Secretary of Defense. If subordinate commanders determine a need for mission-specific supplemental ROE, they forward the request through the CCDR and Chairman Joint Chiefs of Staff to the Secretary of Defense for approval and dissemination. Additional ROE to address the specific circumstances of the operation, and depending on the measure(s) requested, require approval by the CCDR, Secretary of Defense, and the President. The JFC's judge advocate can assist the commander and staff to determine which supplemental ROE measures apply and the reasons why. ROE ensure actions, especially force employment, are consistent with military objectives, US and international laws, and national policies. Joint forces operate in accordance with applicable ROE, conduct warfare in compliance with US and international laws, and fight within restraints and constraints specified by their commanders. Properly developed ROE is clear, tailored to the situation, reviewed for legal sufficiency, and included in training. ROE typically varies from operation to operation and may change during an operation. JFCs ensure the ROE for forcible entry operations provide the commander with the flexibility to accomplish the mission, while assuring adherence to political, legal, operational, and diplomatic factors the force may encounter, including protecting those persons and objects under protected status from attack.

For more information on ROE, see Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Instruction (CJCSI) 3121.01, (U) Standing Rules of Engagement/Standing Rules for the Use of Force for US Forces.

9. Friendly Fire Mitigation

a. The complexity of forcible entry operations increases the potential for friendly fire incidents and demands efforts by all elements of the joint force to deliberately reduce the risk of these incidents. Friendly force tracking provides JFCs with enhanced situational awareness that can help to reduce friendly fire incidents.

b. **Primary Mechanisms for Friendly Fire Mitigation.** To reduce friendly fire incidents, joint forces rely on an accurate common operational picture, clear graphic control measures, disciplined execution of sound plans, thorough training and rehearsal, and effective combat identification. These mechanisms involve integrating maneuver, fire support, airspace control, and air and missile defense operations. Coordination center personnel maintain situational awareness and coordinate closely at all levels to reduce friendly fire incidents. Using fire support coordination measures; coordinating position areas; and considering friendly forces location, friendly international organizations, nongovernmental organizations, and local partners during target analysis all contribute to safeguarding friendly units and partners.

For more information on preventing friendly fire incidents, refer to JP 3-01, Countering Air and Missile Threats; *JP 3-09,* Joint Fires; *JP 3-09.3,* Close Air Support; *and JP 3-60,* Joint Targeting.

c. **Liaison.** Liaison officers provide a means for units to exchange information to enhance situational awareness. Liaison elements provided by supporting components can advise supported commanders on component capabilities and limitations and can assist in the coordination, integration, and synchronization of operations, ultimately preventing losses from friendly fire.

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CHAPTER III
PLANNING

1. Purpose

This chapter provides information on planning forcible entry operations. The joint force follows the JPP and uses the considerations below in planning these operations.

2. Forcible Entry and the Joint Planning Process

The joint force conducts planning for a forcible entry operation during campaign, contingency, or crisis planning. Planners identify the type of plan, time available, and required detail. Campaign and contingency plans vary in scope and level of detail—commander's estimate, base plan, concept plan, and operation plan. During CONOPS development, planners develop flexible options for the JFC that prevent or preempt enemy action, impose multiple dilemmas on adversary or enemy forces, and create operational advantages for the joint force.

a. Forcible entry operations require extensive JIPOE. JIPOE supports JFC planning and decision making by identifying, analyzing, and estimating the enemy centers of gravity, critical factors, limitations, intentions, and COAs the entry force is most likely to encounter.

b. Time, distance, physical attributes of the OA, agreement/arrangement with partner nations, or the current situation may dictate the deployment of a joint force to staging areas outside the United States. The JFC may require authorization to conduct advance force operations in the OA to prepare the OE for the introduction of combat forces. Commanders and operational planners may have to compress planning timelines to meet time-sensitive mission requirements. Time-sensitive situations normally require actions to:

(1) Establish joint staffs and exchange liaison personnel as soon as the JFC defines command relationships.

(2) Conduct parallel planning at all command levels.

(3) Establish the supporting intelligence architecture from national to tactical levels, pre-position airlift, and sealift with supported units.

(4) Load unit sets of equipment and Army pre-positioned stocks (APS) ashore on surge sealift ships at US or allied seaports of embarkation.

(5) Direct the movement of afloat pre-positioning force ships to the OA.

(6) Embark personnel and equipment at US or allied aerial ports of embarkation (APOEs).

(7) Carefully plan for aerial and amphibious embarkation and debarkation, and conduct reconnaissance and surveillance operations.

For further detail on amphibious embarkation and debarkation, see JP 3-02, Amphibious Operations.

c. Forcible entry requires well-trained and well-prepared joint forces capable of executing operations on short notice. Commanders include all key forces associated with the operation in their planning from the onset, ensuring required resources are available in a timely manner and that ample time is available for preparation. When operations require specialists, it is essential that planners identify this requirement early and include the specialists' organizations in planning.

3. Forcible Entry Planning Considerations

The JPP guides planning for forcible entry. It facilitates interaction between commander, staff, and subordinate headquarters, with the JFC's knowledge and experience driving decisions and staff planning. The JFC, staff, and supporting commands consider the following factors when developing forcible entry operations:

a. **Planning Initiation.** The President, Secretary of Defense, or the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff may direct planning for forcible entry operations to respond to a potential or actual contingency, initiate armed conflict, or open a new front during an ongoing campaign. CCDRs and subordinate JFCs may initiate planning on their own authority when they identify a planning requirement not directed by higher authority.

b. **Mission Analysis.** The joint force mission describes the essential tasks, together with the purpose and required actions. In analyzing a forcible entry operation, the JFC and staff consider:

(1) Higher mission and guidance.

(2) A JIPOE, including:

(a) Threat to joint forces en route to, and operating in, the OA.

(b) Geospatial information.

(c) Lodgment terrain and infrastructure, with a critical eye on the ability to support follow-on operations.

(d) A characterization of the information environment.

(e) Enemy centers of gravity.

(f) Enemy's susceptibility to MILDEC.

(3) Operational reach and approach.

(4) Forces available, including multinational and host nation (HN).

(5) Time available and time required to set the conditions for a forcible entry.

(6) Strategic and operational objectives.

(7) Command relationships and force composition.

(8) Combat power required to establish the lodgment.

(9) Operational limitations that may inhibit subordinate commanders.

(10) Initial staff estimates.

(11) Media and public perception.

(12) Consideration of lessons learned and best practices from previous operations.

(13) Availability of MILDEC resources.

(14) Multinational force capabilities, capacity, national caveats for employment of forces, and interoperability.

(15) Available resources and infrastructure necessary to deploy and sustain the forces.

(16) Comprehensive health assessment, including environmental and endemic.

For more discussion on mission analysis, see JP 5-0, Joint Planning.

c. **COA Development.** In the development of a COA, planners address the five elements of forcible entry operations—preparation and deployment, assault, secure the lodgment, introduction of follow-on forces, and transition. To produce a valid COA, planners consider the following (Chapter IV, "Operations," further expands on the five elements):

(1) **Preparation and Deployment.** Considerations should include the following:

(a) Determine which forcible entry option the force will execute, how that operation supports the joint operation or campaign's success, and the command relationships required.

(b) Determine force deployment sequencing that supports gaining access into the objective area, the initial assault, reinforcement, and the introduction of follow-on forces.

(c) Determine lift requirements to support force sequencing, reinforcements, and resupply of forcible entry forces.

(d) Determine local land, air, and maritime superiority requirements to conduct the forcible entry operation.

(e) Determine integration requirements for information forces to conduct and sustain the forcible entry operation.

(f) Determine requirements to gain and maintain cyberspace superiority, EMS superiority, and space superiority to conduct and sustain the forcible entry operation.

(g) Determine requirements to integrate multinational forces into the operation, to include interoperability, information sharing, and liaison teams.

(h) Determine the combinations of decisive points, in all domains, that enable the joint force to create cumulative effects against enemy's centers of gravity.

(i) Determine the conditions the joint force needs prior to initiating a forcible entry (e.g., go/no-go criteria) based on the approved operation.

(j) Plan for culmination and retrograde criteria if the initial or main assault is no longer viable or a higher headquarters ends the operation.

(k) Integrate enabling capabilities (e.g., intelligence operations, surveillance and reconnaissance operations, OIE, CMO).

For more information on abort criteria and go/no-go criteria, see Field Manual 3-99, Airborne and Air Assault Operations. *For more information on culmination, see JP 5-0,* Joint Planning. *For more information on retrograde operations, see JP 3-35,* Joint Deployment and Redeployment Operations.

(2) **Assault.** Considerations should include the following:

(a) Determine how to achieve surprise against an enemy force.

(b) Analyze objectives and potential lodgment regarding:

1. The proposed ground tactical plan.

2. Potential capability for air and sea landing of personnel and equipment.

3. Terrain management within the lodgment and maneuver areas for future operations.

4. Vulnerability to interdiction and counterattacks.

(c) Determine operating facilities or infrastructure to support operations.

(d) Identify forces securing airheads or beachheads (e.g., amphibious advance force, special operations advance force, pre-assault force, LFs).

(e) Plan for reception of reinforcing forces (if required) and follow-on forces for subsequent operations.

(f) Plan for the consolidation of gains in the lodgment.

(3) **Secure the Lodgment.** Considerations should include the following:

(a) Identify the requirements for reinforcing forces and projected deployment flow, with attention to:

1. Cross-loading among lift assets.

2. Task-organization by arrival sequence.

(b) Identify potential restrictions or limitations in force flow and solutions for eliminating or reducing them.

(c) Establish force capability redundancy in deployment flow.

(d) Establish call-forward procedures for reinforcing forces, if required.

(e) Calculate throughput capability of ports of debarkation.

(f) Determine preparation requirements needed to reinforce forces for combat on arrival.

(g) Determine lodgment expansion requirements.

(h) Establish force link-up procedures.

(i) Determine air defense plan/responsibilities, to include counter-unmanned aircraft system.

(j) Identifying aerial ports of debarkation (APODs) and seaports of debarkation (SPODs) requirements.

(k) Determine casualty evacuation requirements.

(4) **Introduction of Follow-on Forces.** Considerations include the following:

(a) Identify tasks for follow-on forces.

(b) Prepare for arrival of follow-on forces.

(c) Coordinate arrival or disposition of afloat pre-positioning force (maritime pre-positioning force [MPF] and APS ships) and equipment ashore.

(d) Determine capabilities of ports of debarkation (e.g., throughput capacity, ramp space, draft, sea states, ammo net explosive weight restrictions).

(5) **Transition.** Considerations include the following:

(a) Continue planning and coordination actions initiated in early phases.

(b) Plan for reconstitution and redeployment of the assault force.

(c) Plan for transition to follow-on operations. Plan for follow-on operations may include the use of nonlethal weapons to limit casualties, collateral damage, and reconstruction requirements. Units should conduct training for the effective use of nonlethal weapons prior to their employment.

(d) Plan for hand-over to civil authorities (if applicable).

JP 3-57, Joint Civil-Military Operations, *provides guidance on transition planning.*

d. **COA Analysis and Wargaming.** The commander and staff analyze each COA separately according to the commander's guidance to bring out their relevant factors. Wargaming provides the means for the commander to analyze a COA and obtain insights not otherwise discernable.

(1) Evaluate the agility and simplicity of each COA.

(2) Analyze the risk of multiple forcible entry sites failing to support each other.

(3) Analyze the risk of unforeseen weather and environmental conditions and their impact on operations.

(4) Analyze the risk of degraded communications between forces.

e. **COA Comparison.** The staff evaluate COAs against COA evaluation criteria developed during mission analysis and wargaming to identify the COA with the highest probability of success.

f. **COA Approval.** The staff briefs the commander on the results of COA comparison, analysis, and wargaming. They also review important supporting information and recommend a preferred COA for the commander's approval.

g. **Plan or Order Development.** Contingency planning results in plan development, while planning during a crisis typically leads to operation order development.

For more information on the JPP, see JP 5-0, Joint Planning.

h. **Red Teaming.** Forcible entry is one of the most difficult and complex operations in warfare. Dynamic factors such as weather, sea states, maintenance readiness of connectors, and training and experience of ship and aircraft crews and LFs are only a few potential single points of failure. These factors significantly add to the difficulty and complexity of the operation. Establishing unity of effort and understanding the accumulation of risk significantly impact the joint force's operational success during forcible entry operations. During forcible entry operation planning, the JFC normally uses red teaming to mitigate the inherent risk and promote a uniform understanding of the

operation. A JFC uses red teams to provide insights and alternatives during planning, execution, and assessment, specifically to:

(1) Broaden the understanding of the OE.

(2) Assist the commander in framing problems and defining operational objectives.

(3) Challenge assumptions.

(4) Consider the perspectives of the enemy and others, as appropriate.

(5) Aid in identifying friendly and enemy vulnerabilities and opportunities.

(6) Assist in identifying areas for assessment, as well as the assessment metrics.

i. **Assessment.** Commanders use assessments to determine the progress of joint forcible entry operations. The commander and staff plan and prioritize assessment early in the planning process. The first step in assessment planning is to gather relevant data and tools that aid in understanding the joint forcible entry OA. The staff uses historical data, guidance, or knowledge of the operation or OA facilitated by JIPOE to develop OE baseline to support mission analysis early in the JPP. The staff uses this data to understand the differences between the current conditions and the desired conditions within the OA. By understanding the current and the desired conditions of the OA, planners, advised by the J-2 on measurable aspects of the OE and how to measure them, can develop assessment measures based on relevant, observable, and measurable indicators. These indicators become urgent intelligence requirements for staff consideration as priority intelligence requirements. The J-2 uses priority intelligence requirements to direct collection, as well as analysis and production, to support continuous JIPOE with all available information for determining changes in the OE relative to the initial planning OE baseline. In this manner, relevant and measurable indicators are determined during planning and revised, observed, and analyzed during execution to assess progress or regression relative to desired effects indicating success or failure of actions. When planning for the relevant effects, measures, and indicators, it is important for the planner to think in terms of the entire OA and capabilities of both friendly and enemy forces. Focusing on the relevant capabilities, resources, and vulnerabilities enables the planner to build performance and effectiveness measures and indicators that anticipate the likelihood of achieving or not achieving objectives. Finally, the planner identifies the reporting mechanisms through which to receive feedback. Feedback mechanisms are the conduit through which the operation acknowledges reinforcement of successful actions or the need to deviate/refocus assets to create a more desired effect within the operation.

For more information on staff estimates and operation assessments, refer to JP 3-0, Joint Campaigns and Operations. *For more information on assessments, assessment planning, and red teams, see JP 5-0,* Joint Planning.

4. Unified Action Participant Considerations

US military forces cannot achieve strategic and operational objectives alone. Other entities, to include United States Government departments and agencies, allied and partner nations, nongovernmental organizations, international organizations, commercial entities, the HN, and local and regional stakeholders, operate within the JFC's AO. These entities may become participants in the joint force's unified action effort before, during, or immediately following a forcible entry operation. To achieve unity of effort, the joint force coordinates and aligns their operations with the activities of these participants.

5. Joint All-Domain Operations Planning Considerations

JFCs conduct joint all-domain operations (JADO) to create windows of opportunity that maximize the chances of a successful forcible entry while reducing risk to the mission and force. JFCs use JADO to integrate and synchronize mutually supporting joint capabilities from all domains to create effects at specific decisive points. The joint force can exploit massed effects at decisive points to accomplish many types of missions, including seizing and occupying terrain, disrupting enemy key C2 nodes, attacking multiple decisive points and operational centers of gravity, and setting conditions for additional offensive operations.

a. JFCs consider several factors when determining whether to integrate a forcible entry into a joint all-domain operation. These factors include enemy courses of action, friendly advantages necessary for success, availability of joint capabilities from all domains, and timing of asset availability and of the forcible entry. JFCs assess these factors and identify opportunities for employing individual or multiple JADO to achieve specific objectives. Once JFCs have a clear understanding of the challenges and opportunities associated with a mission's objectives, they can develop their schemes of maneuver, fires, and logistics. While developing the scheme of maneuver, planners may leverage the unique advantages of a forcible entry operation as a main or supporting effort in JADO. JFCs employ individual joint all-domain operation missions to create effects with limited durations or multiple, successive JADO to take advantage of sustained effects over longer durations.

b. A JFC can employ a forcible entry as part of one or more JADO, depending on their objectives. If seizing and holding a lodgment is the main effort in a joint all-domain operation mission, planners assess the current conditions surrounding the designated lodgment and identify the conditions needed for the successful execution of the forcible entry. Commanders then design supporting efforts to establish those conditions which maximize the chances of success of the main effort. The needed conditions may include establishing local superiority in one or more domains. Planners assess availability of air, land, maritime, space, cyberspace, and EMS capabilities and determine the required effects within each domain. Planners develop a CONOPS that addresses how the joint force integrates available capabilities and synchronizes their actions to create the desired effects. JADO planning goes beyond mere deconfliction of forces—it enables true synchronization of effects across all domains to maximize joint force lethality.

c. In certain forcible entry operations, the joint force may face an enemy capable of extending its A2/AD capabilities across multiple AORs. The enemy may position different components of its space, cyberspace, and fires systems outside of its immediate region to complicate joint targeting efforts. In these situations, supported CCDRs develop a global CONOPS to coordinate the efforts of multiple supported and supporting combatant commands for unity of effort. The joint all-domain operation's CONOPS provides CCDRs with tasks, targets, and desired effects to create within their respective AORs. CCDRs can horizontally integrate efforts across combatant commands or vertically within a single AOR. This enables CCDRs to execute mutually supporting operations in multiple AORs (e.g., a JFC can take an action in one geographically separated AOR as a supporting effort as part of a joint all-domain operation that facilitates a forcible entry in the supported CCDR's AOR).

For more information on JADO and global CONOPS, see JP 3-0, Joint Campaigns and Operations.

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CHAPTER IV
OPERATIONS

"Success in war depends upon the Golden Rule of War. Speed—Simplicity—Boldness."

General George S. Patton, United States Army
Inscribed in his field notebook, 1921

1. Purpose

This chapter provides information on the execution of forcible entry operations. Section A, "Integration and Synchronization," describes the five elements of a forcible entry operation and discusses the integration and synchronization of these operations. Section B, "Enabling Capabilities," focuses on those capabilities that support forcible entry operations, such as intelligence, OIE, and special operations.

SECTION A. INTEGRATION AND SYNCHRONIZATION

2. Introduction

a. **General.** This section highlights some common issues for the JFC and staff to consider as they plan integration and synchronization activities during a forcible entry operation.

b. **Rehearsals.** To integrate, synchronize, and confirm an operation's timing, the JFC normally conducts a rehearsal (see Figure IV-1 for benefits). Rehearsals vary in scope from joint force exercises (constrained by resource, time, space, and force availability) to command post exercises supported by computer-aided simulations or even to conferences involving commanders or key personnel. Factors influencing the decision to conduct rehearsals and how to conduct them include available time and the need to protect critical operational information or indicators.

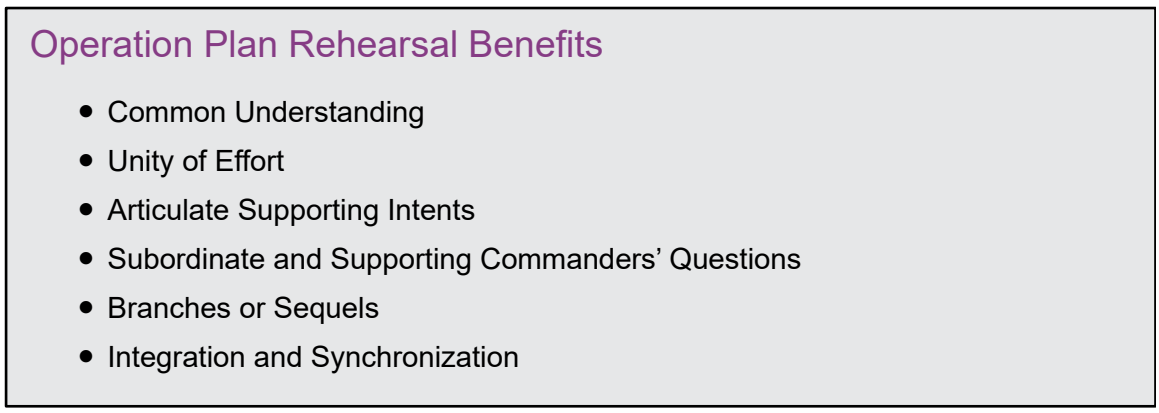


Figure IV-1. Operation Plan Rehearsal Benefits

3. Elements of Forcible Entry Operations

Forcible entry operations comprise five elements listed in Figure IV-2. Planning for the execution of each element should include branch and sequel planning. Each element consists of the major activities performed by the joint force. Appendix B, "Joint Forcible Entry Operations Checklist," provides considerations in a notional checklist format to assist with the planning and conduct of joint forcible entry operations.

a. **Preparation and Deployment.** Forcible entry operations require rapid deployment of forces into an objective area. Joint forces may deploy directly to the OA or to staging areas to prepare for subsequent operations.

(1) **Planning. JFCs are intimately involved in planning and executing the deployment of forces to the OA.** Planning begins as early as possible, including developing contingencies during cooperation or adversarial competition. Staffs should plan a forcible entry as a synchronized and continuous operation. Planners should include representatives from multinational partners and other DoD or United States Government agencies based on the JIPOE, the operation or campaign plan, and relevant information sharing agreements. Planners integrate MILDEC in the joint forcible entry operations plan. Forcible entry operations are one component of a joint operation or campaign. Planners should build upon ongoing security cooperation, military engagement, and deterrence activities that have influenced the OE.

(2) **Movement.** Forcible entry operations involve movement planning from both strategic and operational perspectives. These operations involve movement from marshalling areas and loading and departure from ports and ISBs for the sequenced

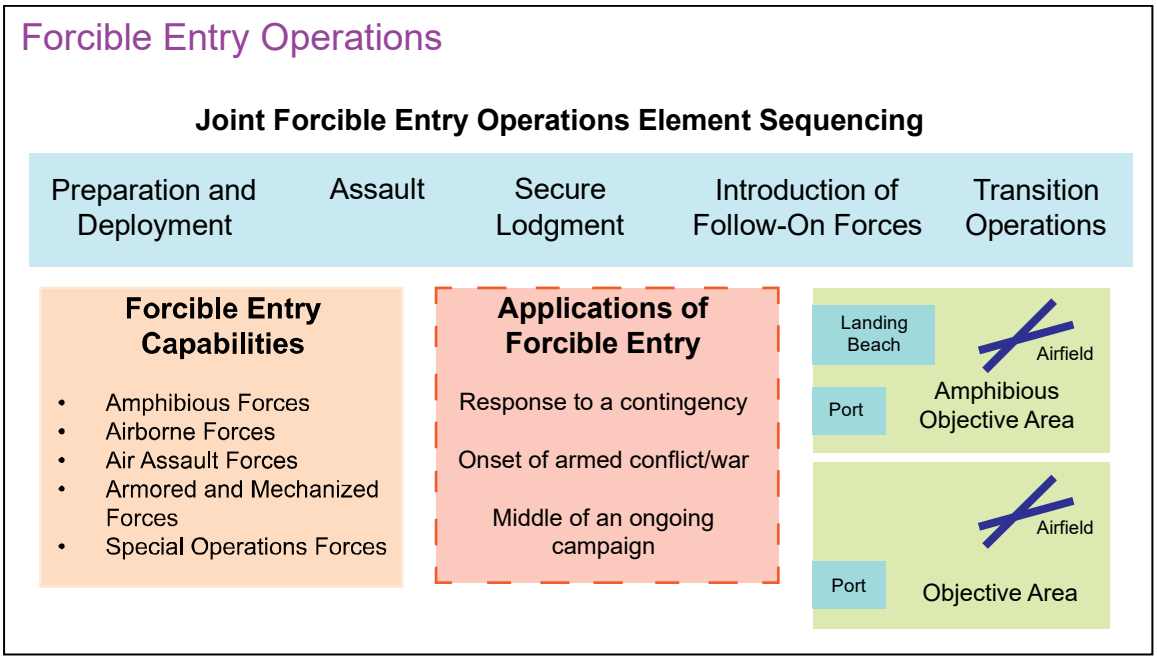


Figure IV-2. Forcible Entry Operations

movement of forces to objective area(s) per the operation order. As time and resources permit, the forcible entry force typically conducts operation rehearsals.

(3) **Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance.** Increased intelligence collection efforts focus on gathering information to satisfy the JFC's priority intelligence requirements and determining if the required conditions for the assault exist (e.g., local air superiority). The JFC may insert SOF reconnaissance and surveillance assets into the objective area prior to the initial assault. Collection efforts include environmental factors such as weather conditions; marine forecast (i.e., currents, tides, waves, swells, wind speeds); flight conditions; signal propagation ranges; and targeting optimization and safe operation limits of the platforms, systems, or weapons planned for use in the mission. The joint meteorological and oceanographic officer provides planners with relevant environmental information necessary for the forcible entry operation. Information about environmental factors supports a commander's understanding of an OE. However, these factors represent only a portion of the factors a commander may consider as a priority intelligence requirement.

(4) **Transition to an Assault.** Support forces set the conditions for a successful assault by isolating the lodgment and achieving local air and maritime superiority. Air interdiction, naval surface fire support, SOF missions, cyberspace operations, or other actions to prepare assault objectives normally occur prior to the commitment of assault forces. Commanders should be aware that diplomatic or operational considerations may preclude conducting such actions prior to initiating the assault.

(5) **SOF Insertion.** In addition to conducting special operations during the assault, the commander may introduce SOF into the area well in advance of a possible assault to develop or prepare an area for forcible entry (e.g., using unconventional warfare or surrogate forces to reduce enemy defensive capabilities). Special reconnaissance may provide detailed intelligence not available by other means. Special operations can be vital to influencing or deterring actions preceding the forcible entry. SOF regional expertise and support to JIPOE are often vital in planning and execution.

b. **Assault.** This element includes joint force assault to seize initial objectives in the lodgment and concludes with consolidating those objectives.

(1) **Initial Assaults.** The initial assault's purpose is to surprise and overwhelm the enemy with decisive force. The commander may employ SOF and information forces in advance of assault forces to identify, clarify, and modify conditions in the OA and to conduct reconnaissance, surveillance, and interdiction operations well beyond the initial assault objectives. Opening entry points will involve actual assault by various combinations of amphibious, airborne, air assault, or armored and mechanized forces to enable follow-on operations by seizing existing ports and airfields or establishing expeditionary facilities. The commander may use SOF in combination with naval forces to conduct assaults to open entry points. Planning for the initial assault may include offensive cyberspace operations and pre-assault strikes by cruise missiles, armed unmanned aircraft, fixed-wing or tiltrotor aircraft, attack helicopters, or naval surface fire support. Planners intend for these attacks to destroy enemy forces in the objective areas; or enemy ground force reserves, aircraft, missiles, WMD,

and naval forces that could disrupt the operation. Assault forces may use multiple approaches and entry points to deceive the enemy and diminish their ability to react.

(a) **Initial Entry Forces.** These are the first forces to enter foreign territory or denied areas. They include both conventional forces and SOF. The initial entry forces' defining characteristic is their ability to insert, apart from infrastructure (such as airfields and seaports), by air, land, or maritime (surface or subsurface) capabilities or infiltration means, as tactically coherent units and formations able to operate immediately upon arrival. Initial entry forces can operate for predetermined periods of time without external sustainment. The concept of initial entry forces (and reinforcing entry forces) is scalable and applies to small entry operations and larger entry operations.

(b) **Reinforcing Entry Forces.** Reinforcing entry forces arrive at the lodgment shortly after initial entry forces land. Reinforcing entry forces (either conventional forces, SOF, or a combination thereof) are more heavily equipped than initial entry forces and increase the fire support, protection, maneuver, or other required capabilities to support initial operations. They do not require reception, staging, onward movement, and integration upon arrival and can operate immediately or shortly after landing. However, the reinforcing entry forces require the initial entry force to establish offload security prior to their arrival. Closing the reinforcing entry forces on the initial objectives quickly is critical to ensuring the survival of the initial entry forces during opposed entry operations. The JFC tailors these forces to meet the requirements of the mission. Reinforcing entry forces may build, repair, or emplace expeditionary infrastructure, such as expeditionary airfields, required to support receipt of follow-on forces and replenishment of logistics for the initial entry forces. Some limited-duration missions may only employ initial entry forces, not requiring the capabilities of reinforcing entry forces. During amphibious operations, the assault follow-on echelon is the echelon of the assault troops, vehicles, aircraft, equipment, and supplies required to support and sustain the initial assault.

(2) **Overcoming Obstacles.** The JFC faces natural and man-made obstacles intended to restrict or halt movement and enable the enemy to mass its forces and repel the assault. In this case, the JFC may require naval mine countermeasure forces to clear transit routes and OAs of sea-based mines or obstacles to facilitate rapid movement of LFs and follow-on forces from the sea. Joint force engineer capabilities provide land-based mobility support to overcome obstacles through breaching, gap crossing, maintaining combat roads and trails, constructing forward airfields and LZs, and conducting traffic management and control. Explosive ordnance disposal personnel and combat engineers enhance the mobility of assault forces on land by clearing roads and airfields of explosive hazards and other obstacles.

For more information on overcoming obstacles, see JP 3-34, Joint Engineer Operations; *JP 3-15,* Barriers, Obstacles, and Mines in Joint Operations; *and JP 3-42,* Joint Explosive Ordnance Disposal.

(3) **Main Assault.** Assault forces can enter objective areas via parachute assault, air LF assault, helicopter-borne air assault, tiltrotor aircraft assault, amphibious assault, or

by land with armored and mechanized forces. During the initial and main assaults, **LFs require immediately available joint fire support** to destroy, interdict, or suppress enemy forces and missile defense. The joint force maintains the initiative and rapidly prepares to receive follow-on forces to develop the combat power necessary to secure the lodgment. Close air support and naval surface fire support are critical resources during the assault. Depending on resources available, the JFC may introduce the LF accompanied by simultaneous strikes against other key enemy assets throughout the OA to prevent the enemy's ability to react effectively. The entry force deploys rapidly, and the JFC employs it immediately upon arrival without the requirement for reception, staging, onward movement, and integration.

MINES AT WONSAN—KOREA, 1950

During the rapid advance following the Inchon landing and breakout from Pusan, United States and ROK [Republic of Korea] forces advanced rapidly up the eastern coast. The United States X Corps planned for an amphibious assault at Wonsan, the only useable North Korean landing area.

Evidence began to mount that the North Koreans were mining the coastal waters of North Korea. Three United States ships, the Brush, Mansfield, and Magpie, struck mines and suffered heavy damage. Although intelligence sources indicated enemy mines were being laid in coastal waters, little was known about the location and extent of these mine fields. North Korean interests certainly dictated, however, that the sea approaches to Wonsan should be mined.

In a series of conferences from 2 to 4 October, Admiral Struble and his staff decided to form the Advance Force Joint Task Force 7, which would proceed to the objective area and begin minesweeping at the earliest possible date. All minesweepers available were to be concentrated for the task. The group comprised 21 vessels, including 10 American and 8 Japanese minesweepers, and 1 South Korean vessel used as a minesweeper. Minesweeping operations at Wonsan began on 10 October. A search by helicopter over the harbor channel showed it to be heavily mined inside the 30-fathom curve. The plan to sweep this channel was canceled and another substituted — to sweep from the 100-fathom curve down the Russian Hydropac Channel passing between Yodo and Hwangt'o-do Islands. By 12 October this channel had been swept a distance of twenty-four miles from the 100-fathom curve. Ten miles remained to the inner harbor.

At this point the novel idea was advanced of exploding mines along a narrow passageway by aerial bombing which would permit the lead sweeps to pass.

On 12 October, 39 planes from the carriers Philippine Sea and Leyte flew down the Russian channel dropping 1,000-pound bombs.

Three minesweepers, the Pirate, Pledge, and Incredible, then entered the bombed channel to resume minesweeping. Northwest of Yo-do Island the Pirate struck a mine at 1209; the Pledge hit one six minutes later. Both vessels sank. As the Incredible, third in line, maneuvered into safe water, enemy shore batteries opened fire. Twelve men went down with the two sunken ships. One enlisted man died later from wounds. At least 33 others were wounded and injured in varying degrees; some sources place the number of wounded as high as 99. The Incredible itself rescued 27 survivors.

The menace of shore batteries was removed on 17 October when ground forces of the ROK I Corps, which had already captured Wonsan, gained control of the peninsulas and islands commanding the harbor approaches.

Casualties from mines continued. On 18 October two ROK Navy vessels struck mines in the Wonsan area; one was disabled at the entrance to the harbor, and the other, a minesweeper, was sunk. The next day a Japanese minesweeper struck a mine and sank. The risk of sending transports with troops to the beaches was still great. The presence of ground mines in the shallow water made necessary a thorough magnetic sweep of the close-in approaches to the landing beaches. Because troops of the ROK I Corps were now well past Wonsan, the military situation did not warrant an unnecessary risk in unloading the Marine units. Admiral Struble, therefore, recommended that they not be unloaded on 20 October as planned, but that D-day be deferred until the minesweeping could be completed. Admiral Joy and General MacArthur concurred.

South to the Naktong, North to the Yalu
Roy E. Appleman, 1961

(4) **Transition to Secure the Lodgment.** The main assault may transition to offensive, defensive, or retrograde operations as described by the JFC's operational concept and by introducing follow-on forces to assist in securing the lodgment and proceeding to follow-on operations without an operational pause.

c. **Securing the Lodgment.** Securing the lodgment requires stabilization to protect the force to enable continuous landing of personnel and materiel, organizing the lodgment to support the increasing flow of forces and logistic resource requirements, and expanding the lodgment to support the joint force in preparing for and executing follow-on operations. Force buildup begins with securing objectives by assault forces consistent with the overall operation or campaign plan's proper balance of combat forces and logistics to conduct subsequent operations. The joint force takes immediate steps to optimize lodgment throughput capabilities.

(1) **Securing the Lodgment.** The entry force secures and protects the lodgment to enable it to serve as an entry point for follow-on forces and sustainment. The JFC analyzes the threat faced and forces available to determine the adequacy of the lodgment

and may expand it as required. Lodgment security is continuous and enables organization and expansion.

(2) **Organizing the Lodgment.** The commander considers the details concerning the introduction of follow-on forces during initial planning and introduces reinforcing entry forces based on the tactical situation and exploits all means of delivery to maximize combat power in the lodgment. Forces secure and repair APODs and SPODs and establish appropriate logistic and communications infrastructure as quickly as possible to facilitate the reception of follow-on forces.

(3) **Expanding the Lodgment.** The commander expands the lodgment to introduce additional combat power and further develop security. During the expansion, the capacity of ground forces to maintain the lodgment in the face of a coherent enemy response should significantly increase.

(4) **Transition to Introducing Follow-on Forces.** Though intended to conduct follow-on operations, in extreme circumstances, the commander may order follow-on forces to assist assault forces in the seizure of initial objectives or help secure and defend the lodgment. Clearing follow-on supplies and equipment immediately from offload points to maximize airlift and sealift efficiency is critical and helps avoid unnecessary operational pauses. The joint force should maintain a high tempo of operations directed against the enemy to prevent the enemy from reorganizing and effectively countering the establishment of the lodgment.

d. **Introduction of Follow-on Forces**

(1) **Purpose of Follow-on Forces.** Follow-on forces provide the JFC with increased flexibility to conduct operations as required by operational conditions. Once the force establishes a lodgment with APODs and SPODs, the commander may identify and develop a joint security area to facilitate and provide security for subsequent support operations. Follow-on forces and equipment may flow via air and sea LOCs into the APODs and SPODs or ground LOCs located within the now-established lodgment. Follow-on forces normally require reception, staging, onward movement, and integration activities before they can conduct operations and arrive using the existing airfields and seaports or expeditionary airfields and seaports. Joint logistics over-the-shore operations can commence in earnest once follow-on forces are in place. Follow-on forces may deploy to the OA to link up with pre-positioned equipment. Initially, follow-on forces establish airfields and begin airfield operations security (OPSEC) in accordance with currently published guidance (see Army Techniques Publication 3-17.2/Marine Corps Reference Publication 3-20B.1/Navy Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 3-02.18/Air Force Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 3-2.68, *Multi-Service Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures for Airfield Opening,* and JP 3-36, *Air Mobility and Sealift Operations)* and in accordance with any valid Service or multinational agreements or plans. Once the airfield is secure and open for full operations, the force can make improvements to increase aircraft maintenance and parking capacity. Follow-on force equipment may flow from pre-positioned stocks.



The joint force can employ vertical lift assets such as the V-22 to maintain the initiative and to develop the combat power necessary to secure the lodgment.

(2) **Ground Offensive Operations.** In some campaigns and joint operations, the follow-on forces conduct ground offensive operations to link up with forces in the lodgment. This involves offensive operations conducted by forces from the lodgment in conjunction with the attacks conducted by friendly forces beyond the lodgment. At Anzio, in 1944, reinforced Allied forces succeeded in breaking out of the lodgment and linking up with the United States Fifth Army as part of a larger offensive across the Italian peninsula.

(3) **MPF and APS.** MPF and APS options provide the JFC with significant combat capabilities to initiate or prosecute follow-on operations. Fundamental requirements to provide MPF or APS for a forcible entry operation include intertheater lift and a secure environment (e.g., arrival airfields, ports, beaches) for arrival, off-load, and assembly of forces.

(a) **MPF.** The purpose of an MPF operation is to rapidly establish a Marine air-ground TF ashore that is prepared to conduct military operations.

(b) **APS.** When available, the APS provides the CCDR or designated subordinate JFC with a similarly responsive brigade-size armored force that can be employed rapidly in response to a contingency. Like the MPF, this capability consists of the equipment required by brigade combat teams and enabling units to conduct a wide range of operations.

(4) **Follow-on Force Preparation for Subsequent Operations.** Ideally, JFCs organize and tailor follow-on forces so they are ready for combat upon arrival in the

lodgment. However, in most situations, follow-on forces require time to link up with equipment, organize, and prepare for operations that follow the forcible entry.

e. **Transition.** The transition from a forcible entry operation to subsequent operations is integral to deployment planning. Commanders complete successful forcible entry operations through achievement of the campaign or operational objectives and establish a lodgment for follow-on combat operations (transition). A forcible entry operation is only one stage of a campaign or joint operation. As such, the forcible entry operation establishes the conditions for follow-on operations. Follow-on forces generally focus on executing sequels to the forcible entry operation to achieve additional objectives. These sequels include the operations and activities depicted in JP 3-0, *Joint Campaigns and Operations,* as part of the larger operation.

4. Integration and Synchronization Considerations

The following discussion illustrates the type of activities that may occur at the JFC level to integrate and synchronize a forcible entry operation. This list is not all-inclusive but presents activities for JFCs and staffs to consider when synchronizing a forcible entry operation. The example assumes the JFC's use of a combination of forcible entry capabilities to obtain a lodgment is the initial operation of a larger operation or campaign. During planning, commanders establish conditions for transitioning between elements.

a. **Preparation and Deployment**

(1) Staff develops accurate time-phased force and deployment data through level 4 detail.

(2) JFC assigns complementary and deconflicted missions to components.

(3) JFC delineates command relationships.

(4) Units conduct rehearsals.

(5) JFC determines and prioritizes component's intelligence effort.

(6) JFC makes initial air apportionment decisions.

(7) JFC issues, staff disseminate targeting guidance.

(8) JFC validates desired arrival sequence of forces in the time-phased force and deployment data and their available transportation schedules.

(9) JFC completes integration and synchronization with other (if any) operations.

(10) JFC integrates military activities that support communication themes and messages (e.g., psychological operations, public affairs, defense support to public diplomacy).

(11) JFC executes MILDEC operations.

(12) Joint force conducts advance force operations (e.g., air, maritime, space, cyberspace, and EMS superiority; preparation of the OE; isolation), to include SOF conducting required special operations core activities, including unconventional warfare operations.

(13) Staff plans sustainment activities and requirements.

(14) Staff formulates casualty and medical evacuation plans.

(15) JFC develops fire support coordination and airspace coordinating measures.

(16) JFC positions surveillance assets in the assault areas.

(17) Conditions are set for the initial assault.

b. **Assault**

(1) JFC reassesses the air apportionment plan and revises it as necessary.

(2) Joint force synchronizes H-hour (specific time an operation or exercise begins) across all assault forces.

(3) JFC modifies and deconflicts existing plans and branches or sequels.

(4) JFC activates fire support coordination and airspace coordinating measures.

(5) All units complete pre-H-hour activities and staging.

(6) JFC finalizes support relationships among components and modifies them as required.

(7) Provide for casualty evacuation.

c. **Secure the Lodgment**

(1) Execute terrain management plan and adjust as necessary.

(2) Clear the airfield of explosive hazards prior to any repair, maintenance, or operations.

(3) Repair and maintain runways, aprons, taxiways, and parking areas to support continuous air land operations.

(4) Coordinate air defense and counter-unmanned aircraft systems.

(5) Coordinate airspace control.

(6) Provide medical evacuation.

(7) Manage time-phased force and deployment data flow.

d. **Introduction of Follow-on Forces**

(1) Adjust force sequencing as required.

(2) Conduct transition to follow-on forces.

(3) Complete reconstitution or redeployment of assault forces (e.g., embark the LF for a subsequent mission).

(4) Address joint security operations issues.

(5) Dissolve AOA.

(6) Maintain ports of debarkation to maximize and sustain throughput for follow-on forces.

e. **Transition**

(1) Adjust joint force and component missions and command relationships.

(2) Shift priorities of support.

(3) Transition to follow-on operations.

SECTION B. ENABLING CAPABILITIES

5. Special Operations Forces

Special operations are an integral part of forcible entry operations. The JFC integrates their actions and operations to achieve military objectives. The JFC may employ SOF prior to forcible entry operations to conduct special reconnaissance, seize key terrain, organize and train guerrilla forces, and conduct other activities that facilitate the introduction of conventional forces. In the execution stages of a forcible entry operation, SOF can seize objectives, interdict targets (especially those that can severely disrupt the assault to open entry points), and conduct other operations to support the main force. In the closing stages of the operation, SOF play a key role in transition by working with HN, multinational, interagency, and intergovernmental partners.

For more information on SOF, see JP 3-05, Joint Doctrine for Special Operations.

6. Fires

In forcible entry operations, initial assault forces build combat power in the OA as quickly as possible. They normally have minimal or no indirect fire support available in the early stages of the operation. Fires from aircraft (manned/unmanned) and naval

platforms (surface/subsurface) take on added importance to compensate for the lack of organic indirect fires and limited ammunition. The supported commander establishes the priority, timing, and effects of all fires within the boundaries of the designated OA.

For more information on fire support, see JP 3-09, Joint Fires, *and JP 3-09.3,* Close Air Support.

7. Intelligence Support and Considerations

a. The JFC uses intelligence to decide what, why, when, where, and how to attack; determine forcible entry capabilities and task organization required to seize initial objective(s); support targeting and combat assessment; and anticipate future operations (see Figure IV-3). Counterintelligence helps the JFC maintain the element of surprise essential to forcible entry operations by supporting OPSEC and MILDEC.

b. Intelligence considerations for the five elements of a forcible entry operation include:

(1) **Preparation and Deployment.** Specific considerations during this phase include the following:

(a) **Establishing the Intelligence Architecture.** The intelligence architecture should be capable of supporting joint forces en route to and within the OA. Architecture planning considers establishing connectivity over long distances between the joint force, the

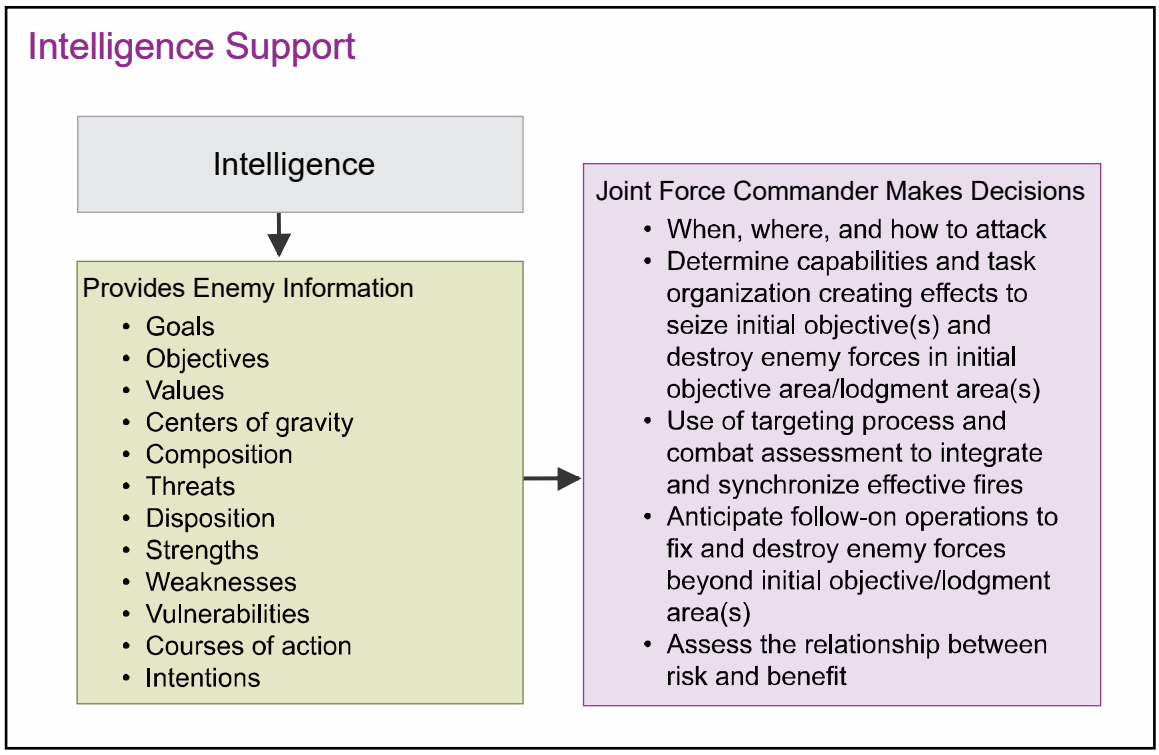


Figure IV-3. Intelligence Support

supporting theater joint intelligence operations center, and other defense and national intelligence organizations (to include federated intelligence partners) outside the OA.

(b) **JIPOE.** JIPOE is a key input to mission analysis and the process continues to refine and update intelligence products to provide commanders and staff the means to prosecute operations successfully.

For further guidance on intelligence support, see JP 2-0, Joint Intelligence, *and the* Joint Guide for Joint Intelligence Preparation of the Operational Environment.

(2) **Assault.** The joint force is most vulnerable to enemy action during the assault. Effective warnings, targeting support, collection management to track enemy reaction to the assault, and force protection are paramount concerns during the initial and main assault.

(3) **Secure the Lodgment and Introduction of Follow-on Forces.** During the operation, intelligence assets within the lodgment increase in numbers, contributing to an enhanced collective intelligence capability. If the joint force headquarters deploys into the lodgment, the J-2 ensures the availability of sufficient assets to assure uninterrupted intelligence support to the joint force. The J-2 should anticipate an increase in the demand for human intelligence and counterintelligence assets to conduct intelligence interrogation; intelligence collection; and document, materiel, biometric, and forensic exploitation and support liaison with the HN country team and with any multinational forces introduced into the lodgment.

(4) **Transition Operations.** Upon executing a successful forcible entry initiating a joint operation or campaign, the JFC shifts the focus of intelligence support from establishing the lodgment to sustainment operations. Intelligence support for sustainment operations, planned during the initial stages of the operation and continually refined as the forcible entry operation progresses, enables a seamless transition for the JFC to begin executing the specific sequel to achieve joint operation or campaign objectives. In some instances, follow-on operations are stabilization activities or other civil-military actions. These operations encompass a variety of activities that vary in their respective intelligence support requirements. Some operations (e.g., show of force, noncombatant evacuations) may require the same level of support required by combat operations. Other operations, such as foreign humanitarian assistance or counterdrug operations, may not involve combat operations but require intelligence support to plan and execute.

8. Operations in the Information Environment

OIE are integral to successful military operations and are key during forcible entry operations. The JFC considers the full impact of OIE on friendly, neutral, and hostile forces with the key goal of OIE achieving and maintaining information superiority for the United States and its allies and exploiting enemy information vulnerabilities. Information activities are the integrated employment, during military operations, of information forces in concert with other lines of operation to influence, disrupt, corrupt, or usurp the decision making of enemies and adversaries while protecting our own.

For more information on OIE, see JP 3-04, Information in Joint Operations.

a. OIE is a key component in setting the conditions for the operational success of forcible entry. OIE efforts are central to achieving surprise and isolating the lodgment and are an important enabler for gaining control of the AO and neutralizing enemy forces. OPSEC and MILDEC, combined with actions of other information forces, assist in achieving operational and tactical surprise during the forcible entry operation.

OPERATIONS SECURITY FAILURE—SOMALIA, 1992

In 1992, the United States committed forces to Somalia in response to devastating famine, made much worse by civil war and the complete collapse of the Somali government. The initial forces committed by Joint Task Force RESTORE HOPE were special operations forces (SOF) reconnaissance teams preceding the landing force onto designated beaches. As they emerged from the water onto the beach, the SOF elements were surrounded by reporters and cameras, together with video crews and flood lighting. Not only were the reconnaissance teams exposed and pinpointed, they were blinded and restricted as they attempted to complete their mission.

Humanitarian Military Intervention
Taylor Seybolt, 2007

(1) OPSEC denies the enemy and adversary the critical information and indicators needed to assess friendly capabilities and intentions correctly. Forcible entry forces preparing for deployment have large amounts of equipment requiring movement to staging bases. Masking the movement of forces to SPODs, APODs and the OA is essential to protect critical information and indicators from adversary collection. While commanders may not be able to hide these movements completely, they should develop plans that conceal details such as the composition of the forces or the time and location of the forcible entry. The object is to surprise, confuse, or paralyze the enemy. OPSEC is a force multiplier that can maximize operational effectiveness by saving lives and resources when fully integrated into operations, activities, plans, exercises, training, planning, execution, and assessment.

For more information on OPSEC, see JP 3-55, Joint Operations Security.

(2) MILDEC misleads enemy decision makers regarding friendly military capabilities, intentions, and operations, thereby causing the enemy to take specific actions (or inactions) that contribute to accomplishing the friendly mission. Commanders integrate MILDEC into the operational scheme of maneuver. A deception operation has little effect if compromised by poor OPSEC or other portions of the operation present competing observables. A lack of logistical support for alleged imminent operations can expose MILDEC operations. Successful MILDEC operations require sufficient resources, leadership, and linked objectives and goals from the strategic to tactical level. The commander may plan and execute MILDEC operations in support of forcible entry operations to achieve the following:

(a) Deceive the enemy as to the time, location(s), and strategic and operational purpose of the forcible entry.

(b) Focus enemy attention and effort away from actual assault objectives.

(c) Cause the enemy to disperse forces to defend all possible airheads and beachheads in the OA so the enemy cannot mass decisive force to deny joint force assaults.

(d) Induce the enemy to piecemeal resources.

(e) Desensitize the enemy to US actions by appearances of routine activities.

(f) Force the enemy to maintain heightened states of alert and readiness for extended periods of time.

MILITARY DECEPTION OPERATIONS USING SPECIAL OPERATIONS FORCES DURING OPERATION DESERT STORM— KUWAIT, 1991

From 29 January until 16 February 1991, Naval Special Warfare Task Group elements conducted near-shore and off-shore reconnaissance missions in support of United States Central Command's deception strategy to fix Iraqi attention on a potential amphibious assault by United States Marines. The special reconnaissance missions resulted in the collection of information, established a naval presence along the Kuwaiti coast, and focused the attention of the Iraqi command on a possible maritime invasion. The deception effort culminated in a major operation on the night of 23-24 February 1991, the eve of the ground offensive, which simulated a beach reconnaissance and clearing operation. The deception campaign prevented Iraqi units at the beaches from reinforcing those being attacked in the west.

***United States Special Operations Command History,* 2nd Edition**

For more information on MILDEC, see JP 3-54, Joint Doctrine for Military Deception.

b. The commander isolates the lodgment from nearby enemy military forces and from C2 centers outside the OA. Cyberspace operations and electromagnetic warfare, supported by physical attack on C2 networks, may play a decisive role in achieving this isolation.

c. **Other Capabilities**

(1) **Defense Support to Public Diplomacy.** Defense support to public diplomacy consists of activities and measures taken by DoD components, not solely in the area of OIE, to support and facilitate public diplomacy efforts of the United States Government. Defense support to public diplomacy requires coordination with interagency partners and among DoD components.

(2) **CMO.** Properly executed CMO during forcible entry operations can reduce potential friction points between the civilian population and the joint force, specifically by

eliminating interference with military operations and limiting the impact of military operations on the populace. CMO encompass the activities a commander takes to establish, maintain, influence, or exploit relations between military forces and local populations and institutions by directly supporting the achievement of objectives relating to reestablishing or maintaining stability within a region or HN. Using civil affairs forces and units specifically organized, trained, and equipped to conduct civil affairs operations in support of CMO can assist the commander.

For further details on CMO, refer to JP 3-57, Joint Civil-Military Operations.

9. Public Affairs

Public affairs plans are prepared during the planning process and executed upon initiation of the forcible entry operation. Public affairs planning should anticipate detection of all but small covert operations by the enemy and the press.

For more information on incorporating public affairs in the planning process, see JP 3-61, Joint Public Affairs.

10. Electromagnetic Warfare

Electromagnetic warfare includes military action involving the use of electromagnetic energy to control the EMS or to attack the enemy. The JFC's plan includes all-domain fires (including electromagnetic attack) to effectively disrupt or destroy enemy C2 and weapons systems, while protecting joint force capabilities.

For additional information on electromagnetic warfare, see JP 3-85, Joint Electromagnetic Spectrum Operations.

11. Chemical, Biological, Radiological, and Nuclear Considerations

The enemy may employ CBRN weapons at any point in the conflict and at locations critical to the joint force's forcible entry operation. When facing an enemy known to have the capability and willingness to employ CBRN weapons/devices, planners should consider the need for protective clothing, decontamination, and logistical support to mitigate effects and enable the force to continue the mission. Additional considerations may include specialized training for the assault forces and follow-on forces at ISBs or additional CBRN units to support operations. An enemy could employ, or threaten to employ, nuclear weapons to disrupt, degrade, or destroy friendly forces. Even a low-yield (i.e., "tactical") nuclear weapon would create effects across the levels of warfare. In the event of a threatened or actual nuclear detonation, the joint force should be prepared to conduct conventional-nuclear integration and to survive the use of nuclear weapons, reconstitute critical capabilities, and plan and execute in a nuclear environment.

For additional guidance, see JP 3-11, Operations in Chemical, Biological, Radiological, and Nuclear Environments, *and JP 3-40,* Joint Countering Weapons of Mass Destruction. *For additional guidance on conventional-nuclear integration, see JP 3-72,* Joint Nuclear Operations.

12. Air Mobility and Sealift Operations

a. Air mobility forces enhance other forces' combat power and flexibility by extending their range, bolstering their staying power, or providing them with greater maneuverability. Airlift enables employment of joint forces by airdrop and airland insertion over strategic distances without delays caused by terrain or obstacles. The Commander, United States Transportation Command, may retain operational control of air mobility forces or may transfer it to the theater commander. Effective utilization of air mobility and sealift capabilities requires detailed planning.

b. Sealift operations consist of the afloat pre-positioning and ocean movement of military materiel in support of US and multinational forces. Sealift utilizes government-owned and commercial ships to move resources that provide for the strategic deployment of large volumes of equipment, materiel, and personnel over vast distances. The success of sealift operations depends heavily on access to a secure port for the safe and efficient loading and off-loading of cargo. The JFMCC makes recommendations to the JFC regarding sealift and seabasing.

For additional guidance on air mobility and sealift operations, see JP 3-36, Joint Air Mobility and Sealift Operations.

13. Engineer and Explosive Ordnance Disposal Operations

a. JFCs plan for engineer support during forcible entry operations. Combat engineers support mobility of the initial entry forces, counter the mobility of enemy forces during the assault and lodgment, and support forward aviation ground units by conducting forward aviation combat engineering operations. General engineer forces may also be required to expediently repair existing infrastructure or build expeditionary infrastructure for receipt of follow-on forces and replenishment of logistics for the initial entry forces.

b. JFCs plan for explosive ordnance disposal forces that locate, access, identify, diagnose, render safe/neutralize, recover, exploit, and dispose of weapons and explosives that threaten personnel, including captured enemy ammunition, unexploded explosive ordnance, improvised explosive devices, and CBRN munitions.

c. The JFC likely faces a dramatic improvement and proliferation of weapons and other technologies capable of denying access to, or freedom of action within, an OA. These may come from advanced technologies or innovative use of basic, even crude, capabilities. Typical of these crude capabilities are clandestine networks employing improvised devices, to include improvised explosive devices.

For additional information on engineering, see JP 3-34, Joint Engineer Operations, *and for details on countering improvised threats, see JP 3-25,* Joint Countering Threat Networks. *For additional information on explosive ordnance disposal and improvised explosive devices, see JP 3-42,* Joint Explosive Ordnance Disposal.

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CHAPTER V
SUSTAINMENT

"The great question of the campaign was one of supplies."

General William T. Sherman
***Memoirs of General William T. Sherman*, Volume II, 1875**

1. Purpose

This chapter provides information on planning, executing, and assessing sustainment and logistics during forcible entry operations. The joint force uses existing logistics functions and sustainment considerations to support forcible entry operations.

2. Forcible Entry and the Core Logistics Functions

To meet necessary sustainment requirements, joint logisticians understand, address, and integrate the core joint logistics functions into forcible entry operations (see Figure V-1). Core logistics functions provide a framework to facilitate integrated decision making, enable effective synchronization and allocation of resources, and optimize joint logistics processes.

See JP 4-0, Joint Logistics, *for additional information on the core logistics functions.*

3. Logistics Planning for Forcible Entry Operations

a. Logistics is more than support. Logistics enables commanders to achieve objectives by increasing the JFC's ability to meet operational requirements in terms of forces, movement, projection, sustainment, duration of operations, redeployment, and retrograde. Logistics planning requires deliberate and thorough preparation and should address the requirements for the entirety of the operation.

b. Logistics planning accounts for the rapid and early resupply of initial assault forces. Initial assault forces have limited on-hand capacity and may consume supplies well above normal rates. This requires commanders to plan and establish logistics systems that flow sufficient equipment and material through the lodgment to support follow-on operations.

c. Planners consider multiple factors when determining the combination of capabilities needed and linkup requirements to sustain forces. It is critical that planners understand the capabilities and limitations of the theater infrastructure and asset availability to support forcible entry operations. Planners assess the available physical and resource network to determine the assets needed to augment or enhance logistics operations. This assessment is a basis for determining the deployment of personnel, equipment, and materiel.

d. JFCs should consider specific sustainment planning factors when planning joint forcible entry operations (see Figure V-2). Appendix B, "Joint Forcible Entry Operations Checklist," provides considerations in a notional checklist format to assist with the planning and conduct of joint forcible entry operations.

Core Logistics Functions

Core Functions	Functional Capabilities
Deployment and Distribution	• Move the force • Sustain the force • Operate the joint deployment and distribution enterprise
Supply	• Manage supplies and equipment • Inventory management • Manage global supplier networks
Maintenance	• Depot maintenance operations • Field maintenance operations • Equipment reset
Logistics Services	• Food service • Water and ice service • Contingency base services • Hygiene services • Mortuary affairs
Operational Contract Support	• Contract support integration • Contracting support • Contractor management
Engineering	• General engineering • Combat engineering • Geospatial engineering
Joint Health Services	• Force health protection • Health service support

Figure V-1. Core Logistics Functions

For additional information on deployment and redeployment planning, see JP 3-35, Joint Deployment and Redeployment Operations.

(1) **Sustainment Preparation and Deployment**

(a) Conduct sustainment estimate evaluating theater infrastructure, environmental factors, and the availability of logistic assets and HN resources to support operations in contested and denied environments.

(b) Determine command and support relationships across sustainment functions (e.g., common user logistics, medical C2, personnel support structures).

(c) Assess critical infrastructure (e.g., APODs, SPODs, over-the-shore capabilities, intra-theater ground LOCs).

Sustainment Planning Considerations

- Area of Responsibility
- Theater Infrastructure
- Force Flow and Power Projection
- Duration of Operations
- Physical and Resource Networks
- Critical Equipment and Supplies
- Transportation
- Resupply Priorities
- Echeloned Support
- Multinational Support
- Additional Logistics Support
- Replacement Operations
- Redeployment and Retrograde
- Geography
- Number of Forces
- Intermediate Staging Bases
- Logistics Capabilities
- Demands of an Expanding Force
- Asset Visibility and Availability
- Movement Control
- Protection of Logistics
- Host-Nation Support
- Contractor Support
- Personnel and Equipment Augmentation
- Branch Plan/Sequel/Follow-on Operations
- Risk Analysis
- Medical Evacuation of Treatment
- Casualty Collection and Evacuation Zones
- Casualty Tracking and Personnel Accountability
- Chemical, Biological, Radiological, or Nuclear Considerations

Figure V-2. Sustainment Planning Considerations

(d) Identify potential ISB locations and coordinate their role in theater distribution planning.

(e) Identify time-phased logistic requirements.

(f) Develop prioritized transportation and distribution plans.

(g) Determine air, land, and sea LOC requirements to support entry forces and sustain follow-on operations.

(h) Plan for airhead and beachhead resupply (e.g., food, water, fuel, ammunition).

(i) Analyze force health protection and health service support planning considerations.

(j) Integrate force health protection and health service support.

(k) Assess country clearances, multinational logistics support agreements, HN support, and contracted sustainment capabilities.

(2) **Assault**

(a) Analyze potential lodgment area to ensure continuous air and sea landing of personnel, equipment, and logistic resources, paying attention to ensure that infrastructure (e.g., buildings, roads, power supplies) supports planned operations.

(b) Provide adequate medical support and evacuation to support concurrent or simultaneous amphibious, airborne, air, and special operations assaults.

(c) Monitor logistics requirements and integrate support and timelines against operational considerations.

(d) Plan and prepare pre-packaged resupply for assault forces.

(3) **Secure the Lodgment**

(a) Identify locations for transload and exchange operations.

(b) Resolve restrictions and limitations in the capability to support force flow.

(c) Determine means of delivery and capacities of stocks to the point of need to maximize combat power.

(d) Maximize and expand throughput capabilities of APODs and SPODs.

(e) Clear reinforcing supplies and equipment from off-load points.

(f) Expand the lodgment to include maximum on-ground capabilities, throughput, and infrastructure.

(4) **Introduction of Follow-on Forces**

(a) Facilitate the arrival of follow-on forces.

(b) Begin casualty evacuation. Employ strategic airlift for regulated medical evacuation outside of the theater, as necessary.

(c) Begin afloat pre-positioned war reserve materiel and shore-based pre-positioned war reserve materiel operations.

(d) Continue buildup of preplanned supplies and address operating stockage objectives and safety levels.

(e) Initiate general engineering and construction to support follow-on operations.

(f) Conduct reconstitution and redeployment of the assault force for follow-on operations.

(g) Determine equipment disposition and the requirements to prepare and ship the equipment of redeploying forces.

(h) Ensure equipment identified for shipment is available and prepared for shipment at the designated time to minimize the impact on strategic lift.

(5) **Transition**

(a) Continue reconstitution and redeployment of assault forces, as appropriate.

(b) Prepare the force for follow-on, out-of-area operations, such as redeployment to another geographical area.

(c) Prepare for the departure of contracted personnel, transitioning of material and facilities to the HN, foreign military sales, and disposal of equipment and material.

(d) Provide basic services while conducting contract closeout and changes to the contractor management plan.

(e) Enable foreign humanitarian assistance.

(f) Assist with reconstruction efforts while conducting the movement of redeploying forces and equipment.

(g) Retrograde contaminated material with special handling equipment.

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CHAPTER VI
THE FUTURE OF JOINT FORCIBLE ENTRY OPERATIONS

1. Purpose

This chapter examines potential future challenges for joint forcible entry operations by introducing potential changes to the OE to promote discussion, improve visualization of a future environment, and provide potential ways the joint force may overcome these challenges. This chapter is not considered doctrine or a validated concept.

2. Challenges in the Anticipated Future Operational Environment

a. The joint force will face existing and emerging threats in the future OE, including in the information environment and the electromagnetic environment. Rapidly changing technologies enable adversary competition. These technologies may drive the evolution of capabilities in all domains for adversary and friendly forces. This evolution could provide adversaries with capabilities to disrupt mobilizing and deploying joint forces from home stations, interrupt critical communications and connectivity across friendly organizations, and disrupt the employment of capabilities within an OA. Additionally, the evolution of threats may force leaders to think beyond the physical aspects of an OE and drive adaptation in fast-paced and dynamic scenarios. With the joint force's rapid integration of advancing technologies into warfighting, and the cost of those technologies becoming more affordable, the future OE could include more transparency. An increase in transparency may shorten the reaction time for the joint force and make engagements more dynamic and volatile.

b. The most significant threat to forcible entry operations will probably be the adversary's A2/AD employment. Adversaries may prevent or disrupt the deployment of joint forces to a region and disrupt the joint force's freedom of movement in an OA. In the future, adversaries may extend their A2/AD approaches to the continental United States. In these situations, adversaries may prevent or disrupt the joint force from mobilizing and deploying forces from installations and bases long before the initiation of a forcible entry operation. Adversaries can extend their A2/AD through forward basing of forces and technological advances to increase the ranges of lethal and nonlethal capabilities.

c. Adversaries continue to aggressively pursue aims that establish global superiority. Their pursuits will include efforts to build military bases in critical areas within their regions and globally. One goal for these bases in other critical areas is as a means for resource control that may enable the adversary to take advantage of potential rises in global demand for those resources. At the same time, other adversaries may continue to build bases in critical areas to create a buffer zone around their borders while extending their operational reach. Despite different purposes, the location of adversary forward bases has potential impacts on forcible entry operations in terms of potential lodgment sites and departure points.

d. Rapidly expanding competitive technologies may force the evolution and development of new capabilities in all domains. These evolved or new capabilities will

increase the lethality and ranges of weapon systems. The improved capabilities may enable adversaries to disrupt the deployment of forces, critical communication networks, and maneuver of friendly forces during forcible entry operations. The joint force may encounter the following conditions and improved capabilities during forcible entry operations in the future:

(1) **Land.** The joint force will face a transparent and well-defended OA. Adversaries can use advanced capabilities, including advanced, networked, multispectral sensors, to monitor potential assault locations and surrounding key terrain. Adversaries could attempt to identify the joint force's intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance assets and determine where the joint force is focusing its collection efforts. These conditions may make conventional reconnaissance by the joint force especially difficult.

(2) **Maritime.** In tomorrow's highly advanced technological and transparent OE, the risk for maritime operations is the inability to mask surface operations. Adversaries are developing capabilities to track and monitor the movements of naval assets in all weather conditions and during periods of limited visibility. In addition, improvements in surface and subsurface unmanned systems may provide adversaries with capabilities for mine laying and to attack the joint force's surface and subsurface vessels. Additionally, adversaries will continue to modernize and increase the size of their navies. These potentially large and modern navies may challenge the joint force regionally and globally, impacting the ability to conduct amphibious operations. Large navies could establish blockades around potential landing sites. These enemy forces could interdict US and allied naval forces within sea LOCs between US territory and the JOA.

(3) **Air.** As technology rapidly evolves, adversaries continue to diversify and expand their unmanned aircraft systems capabilities. Adversaries are exploiting the opportunity to use unmanned aerial systems as a low-cost alternative to a robust air force. The improved systems will include reconnaissance and surveillance platforms, strike platforms, and loiter munitions, including unmanned aircraft that swarm using artificial intelligence to maneuver and target. Adversaries possessing these capabilities can identify, track, and attack entry forces during the approach to the OA and any time after entry forces arrive at the lodgment.

(4) **Space.** Competition in the space domain continues to intensify as adversaries contend for capabilities that amplify their operational advantages. Lower costs for space-based capabilities make it easier for strategic actors to use the space domain. Smaller nations can receive an outsized capability for their investment. All strategic actors will benefit from lower costs for space-based capabilities and the advancements in capability. As part of this trend, the joint force may see the continued militarization of the space domain. Adversaries will launch more satellite systems with advanced capabilities to improve their ability to use the space domain. These advanced systems may contribute to the transparency of the OA and may provide improved capabilities to conduct electromagnetic warfare in, to, and from space. At the same time, adversaries may build or acquire weapon systems that can degrade, destroy, or disrupt US space-based assets. The employment of these counterspace capabilities may deny the joint force's ability to

use precision-guided munitions, navigation, and communications networks during forcible entry operations.

(5) **CBRN.** The threat of CBRN use by adversaries against friendly forces during operations remains a relevant planning consideration. CBRN attacks may delay and degrade friendly forces before and during the execution of a forcible entry operation. In a possible scenario, adversaries may employ CBRN weapons or hazards on potential assault locations to deny the joint force's use of that location for a limited duration.

(6) **Non-State Actors.** Other actors in the future OE will influence forcible entry operations in myriad ways. Extremists within the civilian population may influence the conduct of operations. These actors can influence public opinion, become a risk factor, and potentially impede or delay a forcible entry operation.

e. Threats to forcible entry operations in the future OE are most pronounced in cyberspace. New and improved cyberspace capabilities, enhanced with artificial intelligence, may enable adversaries to exploit and attack the joint force globally. Peer adversaries continue to build and employ cyberspace capabilities globally to challenge basing and force projection of the joint force. This disruption to basing and force projection may occur well before employment of personnel and capabilities within an OA presenting early dilemmas for joint and partner forces. By disrupting force projection early, adversaries can reduce the capacity of forces available for a forcible entry operation and create more time to prepare defenses.

f. The enemy will threaten the joint force in the EMS in new ways, which could impact the joint force's increased use of and reliance on the EMS.

g. Information management and the information environment will become increasingly vital for the joint force and allied multinational forces. The joint force faces an era of cyberspace attacks, deception, and the use of information to disrupt or delay friendly operations. Adversaries use advances in information technology and their growing capabilities in the information environment as tools to increase the transparency of the future OE. Adversaries will connect news and social media reporting with intelligence collection from military sources. These developments could challenge the joint force's ability to achieve surprise during a forcible entry operation.

3. Overcoming the Joint Forcible Entry Challenges

a. Every generation of the joint force faces new challenges that impact deployments, force projection, and employment of forces during forcible entry operations. At present, it seems the most significant threats to future forcible entry operations are adversary A2/AD approaches combined with transparent OAs. To mitigate these threats, the joint force should increase the speed of deployments, project forces at greater distances, and employ forces in ways that create advantages. As history demonstrates, new technology combined with improved doctrine and novel tactics offer commanders a means to counter these threats and create advantage over adversaries. The vignette highlights the increased forcible entry capability of the United States and allied forces from different conflicts.

EVOLUTION OF FORCIBLE ENTRY OPERATIONS

Advancements in technology provided US and allied commanders with potent options for gaining access to enemy territory from the air, land, and maritime domains. During each conflict, US and allied forces improved existing or developed new forcible entry capabilities and developed new methods for conducting operations.

The Gallipoli Campaign, in April 1915, was one of the first joint and multinational joint forcible entry operations. Allied forces from 12 nations used a combination of air, land, and maritime capabilities to seize a foothold on the Gallipoli peninsula. A naval attack, followed by amphibious landings, presented multiple dilemmas to quell the enemy's artillery forts along the strait in attempts to overcome its defenders. Although ultimately unsuccessful, the operation highlighted the growing capability for allied forces to integrate capabilities from the multiple domains to gain access to enemy territory. Gallipoli's lessons influenced how allied forces conducted forcible entry during the next war.

World War II illustrated pivotal evolutions in forcible entry operations with the introduction of airborne assaults. On June 6, 1944, Operation OVERLORD in Normandy commenced with roughly 156,000 troops from the United States, Canada, and the United Kingdom landing across five separate beaches of Normandy marking the largest forcible entry in history. Operation OVERLORD combined airborne operations, deception, both aerial and naval attacks, and an amphibious assault. The masterful execution of this effort resulted in the liberation of Northern France.

Nearly 80 years later, Operation NORTHERN DELAY began with a joint forcible entry operation in northern Iraq in March 2003. Conventional forces, integrated with special operations forces, executed an airland assault that included an armor capability to fix and destroy Iraqi defensive forces. Operation NORTHERN DELAY exhibited the flexible use of forces to gain entry and push follow-on forces in a landlocked objective.

Improvements in technology enabled the United States and allies to project forces into operational areas at greater distances, faster, and in greater quantities than had the previous generation.

From Sparta to Hostomel: Enduring Role of Joint Forcible Entry Operations
National Defense University, 2024

b. During previous conflicts, the United States and allies launched forcible entry operations from areas near the lodgment site. The mobilization and deployment of US and allied forces to ISBs were free from enemy attacks. The joint force may not have that same opportunity in the future OE. With the extended ranges of A2/AD approaches, the joint force may need to account for enemy attacks against mobilizing and deploying forces at

ISBs or even within the continental United States. Planning for a forcible entry operation and planning for the mobilization and deployment of forces should occur in parallel. Forcible entry planning should account for the enemy's potential to destroy or delay portions of friendly forces needed for a forcible entry operation. Additionally, JFCs should consider the requirement to conduct a forcible exit from home stations and bases, where forcible exit means the joint force fights its way out of home stations and bases.

c. When planning a forcible entry operation, the joint force should consider the following items to account for the impacts of the future OE:

(1) **Land.** Land forces need to overcome the initial challenges associated with seizing a lodgment. The joint force's planning and operational approach should consider what first contact looks like against unmanned systems, long-range fires, and mobile forces. The joint force should plan and implement MILDEC to force the enemy to commit resources away from the designated lodgment or to delay commitment of resources. The joint force should use deception tools replicating the capabilities and forces operating across all domains. Additionally, land forces should develop the ability to maintain the forces in the lodgment and mass combat power quickly while overcoming enemy attempts to prevent the arrival of follow-on forces. These actions should enable the joint force to mitigate operational risk, influence success, and build depth in the OA. The joint force should account for the risk that the enemy will destroy or disrupt fires capabilities needed for forcible entry operations. Advancements in loitering systems can offset this risk for the joint force while providing advantages to the initial entry forces. Loitering munitions may not replace the traditional artillery capability seen today, but they could provide the joint force with an additional fires capability when holding and isolating a lodgment.

(2) **Maritime.** The JFC's ability to use, or threaten the use of, maritime forces during a forcible entry operation remains critical in the future. The threat of amphibious operations creates multiple dilemmas for adversaries. Adversaries choose where to allocate their limited resources to defend against forcible entry operations by maritime and land forces. The future speed and capacity of friendly transport assets may compound the dilemmas imposed on adversaries. Maritime forces provide critical sustainment capability for resupplying and building combat power in a lodgment. Additionally, subsurface operations provide the joint force and partner nations with additional reconnaissance, deception, and fires capacity.

(3) **Air.** Advances in unmanned aircraft systems will create diverse capabilities and capacity for the joint force and its enemies. They may enable the joint force to counter A2/AD capabilities, conduct resupply, conduct C2, and provide fires during a forcible entry operation. As artificial intelligence matures, the integration of autonomous unmanned aircraft systems may facilitate decentralized approaches to operations to overcome A2/AD capabilities. Expect the enemy to use counter-unmanned aircraft systems for intelligence, surveillance, reconnaissance, and direct attack against entry forces. These systems may enable the joint force to offset assault forces from their designated lodgment areas through deception and the use of artificial intelligence. Artificial intelligence could enable the joint force to analyze probable enemy COAs against a forcible entry operation and recommend potential solutions to counter the enemy's actions. While unmanned capabilities offer

significant operational advantages, the joint force should evaluate and assess the employment of these capabilities during forcible entry operations. These systems offer significant advantages in dynamic scenarios but are vulnerable to various defeat mechanisms and may take time to regenerate when lost.

(4) **Space.** The continued militarization of the space domain may require the joint force to protect space-based assets from attacks or sabotage by adversaries. From position, navigation, and timing to communications, the joint force relies on the protected use of the space domain to conduct forcible entry operations. Space-based assets and these systems' capabilities are costly and vulnerable to destruction or disruption. Protecting these systems will require capabilities to counter adversaries' antisatellite systems. New technologies may contribute to the joint force's ability to conduct surveillance, enabling collection on potential lodgment areas and enemy forces within those areas. Adversaries will also have increased access to space-based surveillance of forcible entry forces and lodgment areas, even adversaries who previously were not able to access space, as costs for space capabilities decline and commercial sources for space collection proliferate.

d. Overcoming the challenges posed within the expanding OE, including the information environment and the electromagnetic environment, requires the joint force to use ingenuity, flexibility, and potentially new methods for employing forces. Technology will provide the joint force with options to overcome these challenges, but technology is only part of the solution. The joint force will continue to require leaders who can operate in fast paced and dynamic environments to conduct forcible entry operations.

APPENDIX A
AIRBORNE AND AIR ASSAULT OPERATIONS

1. Purpose

This appendix provides an overview of airborne and air assault operations.

2. Airborne and Air Assault Operations

Joint airborne and air assault operations involve the air movement and delivery of specially trained combat forces and logistic support into an objective area to execute a mission. Airborne and air assault forces provide the commander with the unique ability to quickly respond on short notice and mass rapidly on critical targets. JFCs can launch airborne operations at a considerable distance from the target area with such speed as to cause tactical or operational surprise and prevent effective action by the enemy. Airborne forces can secure, disrupt, or destroy enemy forces, critical installations and facilities, and terrain. Airborne forces can reinforce other US and multinational forces, conduct a show of force, or attack an enemy in isolated areas. Air assault operations increase mobility and freedom of action by providing operational and tactical mobility for joint operations. Air operations enable forces to reduce time and space limitations normally encountered when moving assault forces by land; crossing terrain obstacles; bypassing hostile areas; and attacking, destroying, or seizing objectives deep in enemy territory. Each component can significantly contribute to successfully executing airborne and air assault operations.

a. **Concept.** Airborne and air assault forces conduct operations supporting the commander's mission objectives. They arrive in an AOR intact with weapons, ammunition, and other combat equipment and are prepared for combat immediately. Airborne forces aggressively seize and hold objectives until they linkup with follow-on forces. Commanders usually terminate an airborne operation upon seizure of the objective, linkup with other ground forces, or extraction from the target objective. Air assault operations are precisely planned and vigorously executed to strike over extended distances.

b. **Characteristics.** Airborne and air assault forces share many of the same capabilities. They can provide operational reach, move, and rapidly concentrate combat power quicker than land-mobile forces. Airborne and air assault forces share the same limitations. They depend on the availability of airlift assets, fire support, and sustainment resources. They are highly vulnerable to enemy attack by ground and air forces while en route to the LZ or drop zone and are equally assailable when operating in open terrain against an armored threat or WMD. Environmental conditions and adverse weather can also impact performance. There are four phases of airborne operations—marshalling, air movement, landing, and ground tactical. Air assault operations have five phases—staging, loading, air movement, landing, and ground tactical.

3. Organization and Command

a. **Planning.** The JFC initiates airborne and air assault operations with a planning directive to participating units. The staff distributes the directive through normal command

channels and issues pertinent information to subordinate units. After receiving a directive and preparing the initial estimates and planning, the commander and staff develop a CONOPS. The CONOPS forms the basis for preparing the commander's planning directive and developing operation plans and operation orders, including a list of forces in support; a schedule of events; and stated conditions under which the operation begins, is delayed, is altered, or is terminated.

b. **Coordination.** Airborne and air assault commanders begin planning operations by visualizing the ground tactical plan and working through a reverse-planning sequence. Commanders plan for airborne and air assault operations with as much detail as time permits. For airborne operations, this sequence includes developing a ground tactical plan, landing plan, air movement plan, and marshalling plan. For air assault operations, the sequence is relatively the same, except loading and staging plans replace marshalling plans. Direct liaison and coordination between the logistic support agencies of the participating components and other supporting forces occur during the preliminary planning stages. For airborne and air assault operations, intelligence systems assist in achieving strategic objectives, including all factors impacting the arrival of forces into the objective area, establishment of airheads and lodgments, and linkup of forces in preparation for follow-on operations.

c. **Command.** The JFC may initiate joint airborne and air assault operations in support of strategic or operational objectives. The complexity of airborne and air assault operations and their vulnerability require an exceptional degree of unified action. The JFC issues an order to the airborne or air assault commander to conduct the operation. JFCs establish command relationships and assign authority to subordinates based on the operational situation, the mission's complexity, and the degree of control needed to achieve strategic intent.

d. **Control.** Airspace C2; established boundaries; ability to communicate; and the effective employment of surveillance, reconnaissance, and joint EMS operations are key elements that enable JFCs to effectively C2 airborne and air assault operations. The airborne force commander establishes a standard C2 system by defining the functions and responsibilities of key personnel, ensuring the staff and subordinate commanders have completed preliminary operational planning and published operations plans and orders. Air assault operations feature extended distances and rapid execution. To work swiftly under pressure, commanders integrate and synchronize the operation. Effective liaison between operational elements of an airborne and air assault operation with higher authorities facilitates mutual understanding and unified action.

e. **C2 of Airborne Operations.** Airborne assault, particularly over intercontinental distances, places additional requirements on C2. En route mission planning and rehearsal systems enable the airborne force to maintain situational awareness and to receive and disseminate updated intelligence and guidance from load time at the APOE until arrival at the drop zone or LZ.

(1) The airborne assault force commander accompanies the initial assault and is responsible for (see Figure A-1 for a list of tasks at various command levels):

Example Distribution of Responsibilities for Airborne Assault

	Planning and Preparation	Assault	Follow-on Operations
Joint Task Force (JTF) Headquarters	• Operational planning • Develop time-phased force and deployment data • Intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance planning and integration • Joint shaping operations • Special operations forces integration • Military deception • Exercise of command and control (C2) over intermediate staging base	• C2 of supported and supporting components • Go or no-go decision • Modify force flow based on situation • Apportion and allocate joint support	• Control flow of joint forces
Airborne Task Force Headquarters	• Tactical planning • Integrate joint fires • Integrate reconnaissance and surveillance assets and special operations forces • Control pre-assault fires • Rig and load personnel and equipment	• En route C2 and airspace command and control • C2 relay between JTF and assault force • Expand C2 network on the ground	• Assume overall command of ground forces
Assault Force Headquarters	• Develop ground plan and rehearse ground operations • En route planning • Seize assault objectives • Secure and defend airhead • Control supporting fires	• En route planning • Seize assault objectives • Secure and defend airhead • Control supporting fires	• Expand lodgment • Receive initial follow-on forces • Link-up with special operations forces and amphibious forces • Exploitation

Figure A-1. Example Distribution of Responsibilities for Airborne Assault

(a) Ground tactical planning.

(b) Rigging and out loading personnel and equipment.

(c) En route mission planning and rehearsal.

(d) Conducting airborne assault.

(e) Seizing assault objectives.

(f) Executing joint fires.

(g) Updating the intelligence preparation of the OE.

(h) Securing the APOD.

(i) Repairing and maintaining the APOD.

(j) Expanding the lodgment.

(2) If the assault requires an airborne brigade combat team, the brigade combat team commander leads the assault force, and the parent Army headquarters (normally a division) provides the airborne TF commander. This enables the assault force commander to focus on the airhead and not managing en route follow-on forces and support.

(3) The airborne TF commander initially exercises control from an airborne command post outside the airhead or a secure base with linkages to the airhead and all joint supporting assets. The airborne TF commander's responsibilities include operational planning; APOE situational awareness and integration; en route C2; aerial relay using joint communications; integrating joint fires; integrating long-range surveillance and SOF; C2 of pre-assault fires; C2 of the APOE and APOD; and C2 of reception, staging, and onward movement of follow-on forces. After the assault force secures the airhead, the airborne TF commander moves into the lodgment and assumes command of the assault force and follow-on forces.

(4) The JFC is responsible for joint operational planning; joint integrated prioritized target list development; joint intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance integration; setting the conditions for joint forcible entry; C2; and air flow and air space management.

f. **Forces**

(1) The JFC commits Army airborne forces (parachute assault), air-land forces, or a combination to execute an assault operation. Normally, the airborne TF commander initiates airborne operations by parachute assault conducted by an airborne infantry brigade combat team. Parachute assault permits delivery of combined arms teams into the airhead in less time than air-land operations require. Once the airborne TF commander initiates the assault phase, the joint force executes one or more of the following phases: defensive, offensive, extraction.

(2) The initial assault stresses the coordinated action of several units and capabilities to seize initial objectives before the advantage of surprise has worn off. After the initial assault landings accomplish the initial ground missions, commanders organize the airhead line. Airborne forces defend to protect and retain areas or installations seized during the assault phase of the operation. Because commanders normally conduct an airborne assault in the enemy rear, the assault force conducts an all-around defense. Units airland on terrain under the control of friendly forces near the line of contact or on secured locations in the enemy's rear. However, it takes time to land a sizable force, requiring a secured LZ. Even when commanders employ multiple LZs, it takes longer to mass forces in the airhead during airland operations than during parachute operations. Subsequent operations can include continued defense of the airhead, linkup, passage of lines, relief, withdrawal, or offensive operations, to include exploitation or further airborne and air assaults.

(3) **Air Assault.** Whether performed from the sea or a land ISB, aviation and combined arms provide the JFC with an agile fighting force capable of conducting both offensive and defensive operations. Air assault operations enable friendly forces to strike over extended distances and terrain barriers to attack the enemy when and where they are most vulnerable. Air assault forces normally execute air assaults within short time constraints. During air assault operations, commanders should consider reinforcement of committed units, linkup operations, gap crossing operations, security operations, limited visibility operations, and ship-to-shore operations.

(4) **Sustainment.** Minimum sustainment elements accompany airborne forces into the airhead or lodgment to perform critical services in the marshalling area. Commanders typically organize sustainment elements to support assault, follow-on, and rear echelons. Sustainment elements support operations by distributing supplies, conducting aerial resupply (i.e., immediate, emergency, routine), performing maintenance, coordinating transportation, and providing casualty care and evacuation. Both organic and external elements support the air assault by delivering supplies, materiel, fuel, and ammunition forward by air. The exact organization and disposition of sustainment elements are a function of the air assault force's mission and anticipated follow-on operations. After offloading supplies, commanders may use these same platforms to evacuate casualties. Sustainment planners coordinate closely with medical and aviation elements to prioritize casualty evacuation during the return leg of resupply flights.

4. Transition

a. Airborne/air assault operations normally transition combat operations to follow-on forces. However, the JFC should prepare contingency plans for the possibility that follow-on forces cannot relieve the airborne/air assault force. The follow-on operation is one of the following:

(1) Withdrawal or evacuation of units.

(2) Linkup with ground forces.

(3) Exfiltration.

(4) Breakout from encirclement.

b. As conditions permit, the buildup of forces and supplies continues, and follow-on operations commence. Follow-on forces improve the seized airfield as an airbase suitable for joint operations.

For more information on airborne and air assault operations, see Field Manual 3-99, Airborne and Air Assault Operations.

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APPENDIX B
JOINT FORCIBLE ENTRY OPERATIONS CHECKLIST

This appendix provides a notional checklist to assist with the development of checklists/standard operating procedures for planning and executing control of joint forcible entry operations.

1. Monitor Forcible Entry Operations

a. **Connectivity.** Access to the Global Command and Control System-Joint with United States Transportation Command during the deployment of forces.

(1) Monitor the deployment status of joint forces.

(2) Balance requirements for initial entry operations, joint forces reception and buildup, and timing of required follow-on operations.

(a) ISBs.

(b) Intertheater and intratheater deployment, the establishment of forward operating bases and base camps, and use of seabasing.

(c) Airlift and airdrop capabilities enable shifting, regrouping, or moving joint forces in a theater to obtain operational reach and positional advantage.

(3) Recommend changes to supported CCDR's TPFDD, as required.

b. Monitor operations directed at enemy centers of gravity related to joint operations.

c. Monitor execution of forcible entry operations. Consider:

(1) Preparation and deployment.

(a) Command relationships.

(b) Forcible entry organizational structure.

(c) Horizontal and vertical connectivity through JTF functional areas.

(d) Liaison officers or teams, as required.

(e) Missions assigned to special operations forces (such as direct action and special reconnaissance).

(f) JIPOE.

(g) Airspace control.

(h) Joint targeting coordination board/joint fires element.

(i) Counterair, suppression of enemy air defense, and C-UAS.

(j) Logistic factors.

1. Identify and coordinate for ISBs, as required.

2. Identify time-phased logistic requirements.

3. Develop prioritized transportation requirements and identify all outsized/oversized requirements.

4. Analyze capabilities, limitations, and vulnerabilities of APODs, APOEs, SPODs, seaports of embarkation, coastal areas for joint logistics over the shore, and OA infrastructure to support projected operations.

5. Determine air, land, and sea LOC requirements to support forcible entry and subsequent operations.

6. Determine logistic resupply factors and establish airhead and beachhead resupply responsibility.

7. Analyze force health protection and health service support planning considerations.

8. Analyze or assess multinational support and contractor capabilities to support operations.

9. Analyze and recommend changes to TPFDD flow to ensure availability of adequate support.

10. Integrate and synchronize logistic support of initial and subsequent flow of forces into the OA.

11. Consider these principles when planning for airlift movements.

a. Minimize movement congestion and vulnerability by reducing the time units and materiel are massed at forward terminals and synchronize the positioning of units, materiel, and equipment with airlift capabilities.

b. Maximize the productivity and survivability of airlift forces by minimizing aircraft ground times at forward locations.

c. Minimize sortie requirements by repackaging all materiel for air shipment; ensure combat personnel travel with their basic load of rations, ammunition, or other personal protective equipment; and split units into air-essential and surface-movement echelons (whenever possible).

d. Adequately feed, rest, and protect personnel at en route stops.

e. Deploy personnel and communications equipment to track and report all air movements.

f. Maximize use of available sealift/ground transportation.

12. Planning airlift operations is a complicated process involving a few basic principles and many interdependent considerations. Service components facilitate their airlift movement processes. This responsibility includes performing or arranging to:

a. Bring units and materiel to APOEs/seaports of embarkations.

b. Prepare those resources for air movement.

c. Provide support services (meals, medical, billeting, and other appropriate services) to transient and arriving units.

d. Receive and transport units and materiel from APODs/SPODs.

e. Prepare all manifests, hazardous cargo declarations, movement documents, and reports related to movement.

(k) ROE and control measures.

(l) MILDEC operations.

(m) Joint EMS operations.

(n) OPSEC to prevent disclosure of future operations.

(o) Psychological operations.

(p) CO.

(q) Intelligence collection and dissemination.

(r) Plan for dislocated civilians as necessary.

(s) Conduct rehearsal(s) of activities and operations.

(2) Assault.

(a) Land, air, maritime, and special operations forces in the OA.

1. Support the ground tactical plan.

2. Airborne and amphibious landing of personnel and equipment.

a. Align air mobility forces with airborne, air assault, light infantry, or SOF specifically designed for air delivery.

b. The air drop mission normally involves inserting airborne forces; however, carefully planned air and land assault operations can be equally effective.

3. Designate/assign OAs for maneuver space for immediate and future operations.

4. Vulnerability to interdiction.

5. Operating facilities.

(b) Initial entry forces, including the advance, pre-assault, and assault forces securing lodgment airhead and the AFs securing the beachhead.

(c) Assault forces preparation to receive reinforcing entry forces and assault echelon coordination with assault follow-on echelon.

(d) Plan and rehearse close air support and air interdiction.

(e) Logistics factors.

1. Ensure the lodgment and OA provide for continuous air landing of personnel, equipment, and logistic resources for initial entry, reinforcing entry forces, and follow-on forces and amphibious operations as required.

2. Ensure adequate medical support and evacuation to support concurrent or integrated assaults by amphibious, airborne, air assault, armored and mechanized, and special operations forces.

(3) Secure the lodgment.

(a) Lodgment security, organization, and expansion.

(b) Sequencing of initial entry forces, reinforcements, and follow-on forces.

(c) Link-up of initial entry forces, reinforcing entry forces, and other follow-on forces.

(d) Logistic factors.

1. Casualty evacuation.

2. Resolve restrictions and limitations in the capability to support force flow.

3. Maximize and expand the throughput capabilities of APODs and SPODs.

4. Deliver and clear reinforcing supplies and equipment from off-load points to the point of need.

5. Expand lodgment to maximize ground capabilities, throughput, and infrastructure.

(4) Introduction of follow-on forces.

(a) Arrival of force buildup and follow-on forces.

(b) Refine mission requirements for follow-on forces, as required.

(c) Consider need for a joint security area.

(d) Logistic factors.

1. Begin MPF and APS operations.

2. Continue build-up of pre-planned supplies.

3. Initiate general engineering and construction plans for support to follow-on operations.

4. Conduct reconstitution and redeployment of the assault force for follow-on operations.

(5) Transition.

(a) Initiate actions to support transition early in the operation.

(b) Continue reconstitution and redeployment of the assault force.

(c) Disestablish the JTF and transfer responsibilities and authorities to other interagency partners or civilian authorities as required.

(d) Transition to another JTF headquarters.

(e) Logistic factors. Integrate the core logistics functions: deployment and distribution, supply, maintenance, logistics services, operational contract support, engineering, and health services.

d. Monitor crises, limited contingency operations, and enemy counter-actions related to forcible entry operations.

(1) Counterterrorism.

(2) Counterair operations.

(3) Noncombatant evacuation operations.

(4) MILDEC.

(5) CO.

(6) Stabilization activities.

(7) CBRN response.

(8) Countering WMD.

(9) Personnel recovery operations.

(10) Show of force.

(11) Strikes and raids.

(12) Peace operations, if applicable.

e. Monitor meteorological and oceanographic situation.

2. Assess the Effectiveness of Protection During Forcible Entry Operations

a. Air and missile defense.

(1) Defensive counterair operations.

(2) Offensive counterair operations.

(3) Theater missile warning.

(4) Area air defense plan.

b. Protection of forcible entry operations.

(1) Significant fortifications (e.g., camouflage, concealment, dispersion).

(2) Significant CBRN threats and hazards to forcible entry operations.

(3) Friendly use of the EMS.

(4) Combat identification.

(5) Emplacement of obstacles in support of countermobility operations.

c. OPSEC.

(1) Signal security measures.

(2) Concealment of significant joint forces.

(3) Avoidance of discernable patterns by joint forces.

d. MILDEC.

(1) Mask details of a plan involving forcible entry operations.

(2) Produce misinformation regarding forcible entry operations.

e. Security of forcible entry operations and means.

(1) Enemy options to identify the likelihood of efforts to surprise; observe and detect; or conduct espionage, terrorist, or sabotage operations.

(2) Measures to counteract and protect from such enemy activities.

(3) Physical security of installations, facilities, and systems.

(4) Forcible entry OPSEC operations and requirements.

3. Assess the Effectiveness of Command and Control for Forcible Entry Operations

a. Information architecture.

(1) Incorporate JTF communications and information systems and networks.

(2) Networks, frequency assignments, codes, and navigational aids resolved.

(3) Operational information and forces status.

(4) Procedures for monitoring operational situations involving forcible entry operations.

b. Organization of operational joint forces.

(1) Clear and responsive C2 relationships and authorities.

(2) Unity of effort.

c. Missions to Service and special operations components.

(1) Appropriate for tasked components and units.

(2) Integrated with missions of other components.

(3) Supported by sufficient JTF-controlled resources to include OA and joint fires.

d. Organization of land, maritime, air, and special operations areas in the JOA.

(1) Maneuver control measures provide Service component commanders with sufficient space to accomplish assigned missions.

(2) Force OAs, such as AOAs and JSOAs, continue to support current operations. Commanders disestablish force OAs when no longer required.

(3) Airspace coordinating measures, fire support coordination measures, and other coordination measures provide for efficient use of airspace to support forcible entry operations.

(4) Other OAs support forcible entry operations, as required. Consider:

(a) Joint security area.

(b) Subordinate OAs and distributed operations.

(c) Areas of interest.

(d) AOA.

(e) JSOA.

4. Prepare Plans and Orders Related to Forcible Entry Operations

a. Maintain a current estimate of forcible entry operations.

b. Assess the progress of current forcible entry operations.

(1) Relate information to the achievement of desired objectives.

(a) Current operations.

(b) Projected future operations.

(2) Relate to decision points for current or future operations.

c. Develop friendly COAs supporting forcible entry operations. In developing forcible entry COAs, consider the following actions/activities by forcible entry element:

(1) Preparation and Deployment. Units whose force structures permit rapid deployment into the objective area conduct forcible entry operations. Joint forces may deploy directly to the OA or staging areas to prepare for subsequent operations.

(a) Determine forcible entry option(s), required command relationships, and how those operations support campaign success.

(b) Determine deployment sequencing of initial entry forces that supports gaining access into the objective area, the initial assault, reinforcing entry forces, and introducing follow-on forces.

(c) Determine requirements for local land, air, maritime, and EMS superiority to conduct the forcible entry operation.

(d) Determine forcible entry go/no-go criteria.

(e) Determine logistic factors and establish airhead and beachhead resupply responsibilities.

(f) Determine the feasibility of clandestine infiltration of assets for special reconnaissance before commencing the forcible entry.

(g) Continuation of forcible entry operations following the current apportionment, guidance, and prioritization of targets.

(h) Branches and sequels for forcible entry operations based on the changing situation or additional requirements.

(2) Assault. Joint forces seize initial objectives in the lodgment and consolidate those objectives.

(a) Analyzing objectives and potential lodgment locations:

1. The proposed ground tactical plan.

2. Potential capability for airborne and amphibious landing of personnel and equipment.

3. Space within the lodgment, immediate maneuver area, and space for future operations.

4. Vulnerability to interdiction and counterattacks.

5. Follow-on mission requirements.

(b) Operating facilities or infrastructure to support operations.

(c) Identify initial entry and reinforcing entry forces to secure airheads (e.g., advance, pre-assault, landing forces) and AFs for beachheads.

1. SOF and information forces employed in advance of assault forces.

2. Pre-assault fires, including strikes by cruise missiles, fixed- and rotary-wing wing aircraft, or naval surface fire support.

3. Overcoming obstacles, both land and maritime.

4. Main assault forces and LFs.

(d) Reception of reinforcing forces (if required) and follow-on forces for subsequent operations.

(3) Secure the Lodgment. Securing the lodgment includes organizing and expanding the lodgment.

(a) Identify the requirements for reinforcing forces and projected deployment flow, with attention to:

1. Cross-load among lift assets.

2. Task-organize by arrival sequence.

(b) Identify potential restrictions or limitations in force flow and eliminate or reduce accordingly.

(c) Establish redundancy of force capability in deployment flow for added flexibility.

(d) Establish call-forward procedures for reinforcing forces, if required.

(e) Calculate the throughput capability of ports of debarkation.

(f) Determine preparation requirements needed to reinforce forces for combat on arrival.

(g) Determine requirements for expansion of the lodgment.

(h) Establish force link-up procedures.

(4) Introduction of Follow-On Forces. Follow-on forces provide the JFC with increased flexibility to conduct operations, as required by the operational conditions.

(a) Identify tasks for follow-on forces.

(b) Prepare for the arrival of follow-on forces.

(c) Coordinate arrival or disposition of any allocated MPF and APS.

(d) Throughput capacity of ports of debarkation.

(5) Transition. A successful forcible entry operation establishes a lodgment and other initial operational objectives for transitioning to follow-on combat operations.

(a) Continue planning and coordination actions initiated in early phases.

(b) Plan for reconstitution and redeployment of the assault forces.

(c) Plan for transition to follow-on operations. Plans for follow-on operations may include using nonlethal weapons to limit casualties, collateral damage, and reconstruction requirements.

(d) Plan to disestablish the JTF and transfer authorities and responsibilities to civilian authorities (if applicable).

d. Develop enemy COAs that affect forcible entry operations or current and projected future environmental or civil conditions.

(1) Current operations and conditions.

(2) Branches to current operations and conditions.

e. Prepare a discussion of and a recommendation for the current estimate.

(1) Prepare recommendations for decisions requiring approval by appropriate headquarters.

(2) Recommendations may be formal or informal, depending on the forum and supervisor's directions.

5. Direct and Lead Subordinate Operational Forcible Entry Operations

a. Approve plans and orders related to forcible entry operations.

b. Synchronize actions following established timelines and conditions.

c. Coordinate actions and operations where lines of authority and responsibility meet, overlap, or conflict.

(1) Advise components and units of adjacent or related actions and operations.

(2) Direct supporting operations, as required.

(3) Resolve conflicts.

d. Adjust control measures, as required, or relay component adjustments to adjacent, supported, or supporting units.

e. Decide on actions and directions.

f. Change, recommend changes to, or continue forcible entry operations and priorities.

(1) Seek JFC guidance if a change appears necessary.

(2) Ensure change remains supportive of the current mission and intent based on a continuing estimate of the situation.

(3) Coordinate and conduct appropriate planning for change.

(4) Coordinate changes in forcible entry operations with other operations, to include information activities.

(5) Write plans and orders for branches and sequels.

g. Approve plans and orders.

h. Issue plans and orders.

i. Conduct rehearsals.

6. Acquire and Communicate Operational Information about Forcible Entry Operations

a. Display information.

b. Brief information.

c. Inform supervisors, decision makers, other JTF staff, and staff counterparts.

(1) Preplanned hierarchy of significant information.

(2) Commander's critical information requirements.

(3) Understanding of information requirements of commanders and other staff.

d. Report formally (required and periodic) and informally (hasty, as required).

e. Develop general military information for briefings, reports, and analyses.

f. Supervise communications security, cyberspace security, and signal security related to forcible entry operations.

g. Conduct PA related to forcible entry operations.

APPENDIX C
REFERENCES

The development of JP 3-18 is based upon the following primary references:

1. Department of Defense Publications

a. DoD Directive 5100.01, *Functions of the Department of Defense and its Major Components.*

b. *DoD Dictionary of Military and Associated Terms.*

2. Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Publications

a. CJCSI 3110.10H, *(U) Communications Systems Supplement to the Joint Strategic Campaign Plan (JSCP).*

b. CJCSI 3121.01B, *(U) Standing Rules of Engagement/Standing Rules for the Use of Force for US Forces*.

c. CJCSI 3150.25H, *Joint Lessons Learned Program.*

d. CJCSI 5120.02G, *Joint Doctrine Development System.*

e. Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Manual 3122.05A, *Operating Procedures for the Joint Operation Planning and Execution System (JOPES)-Information System (IS) Governance.*

f. Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Manual 3130.03B, *Planning and Execution Formats and Guidance.*

g. *Joint Guide for Joint Intelligence Preparation of the Operational Environment.*

h. JP 1, Volume 2, *The Joint Force.*

i. JP 2-0, *Joint Intelligence.*

j. JP 3-0, *Joint Campaigns and Operations.*

k. JP 3-01, *Countering Air and Missile Threats.*

l. JP 3-02, *Amphibious Operations.*

m. JP 3-03, *Joint Interdiction.*

n. JP 3-04, *Information in Joint Operations.*

o. JP 3-05, *Joint Doctrine for Special Operations.*

p. JP 3-09, *Joint Fires.*

q. JP 3-09.3, *Close Air Support.*

r. JP 3-11, *Operations in Chemical, Biological, Radiological, and Nuclear Environments.*

s. JP 3-14, *Joint Space Operations.*

t. JP 3-15, *Barriers, Obstacles, and Mines in Joint Operations.*

u. JP 3-30, *Joint Air Operations.*

v. JP 3-31, *Joint Land Operations.*

w. JP 3-32, *Joint Maritime Operations.*

x. JP 3-33, *Joint Force Headquarters.*

y. JP 3-35, *Joint Deployment and Redeployment Operations.*

z. JP 3-52, *Joint Airspace Control.*

aa. JP 3-54, *Joint Doctrine for Military Deception.*

bb. JP 3-55, *Joint Operations Security.*

cc. JP 4-0, *Joint Logistics.*

dd. JP 5-0, *Joint Planning.*

ee. JP 6-0, *Joint Communications.*

3. Multi-Service Publications

a. Army Techniques Publication 3-17.2/Marine Corps Reference Publication 3-21.1B/ Navy Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 3-02.18/Air Force Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 3-2.68, *Multi-Service Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures for Airfield Opening.*

b. Army Techniques Publication 3-52.2/Marine Corps Reference Publication 3-20.1/Navy Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 3-56.2/Air Force Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures 3-2.17, *Multi-Service Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures for the Theater Air-Ground System.*

4. United States Army Publications

a. Army Doctrine Publication 3-0, *Operations.*

b. Army Doctrine Publication 4-0, *Sustainment.*

c. Field Manual 3-05, *Army Special Operations.*

d. Field Manual 3-99, *Airborne and Air Assault Operations.*

5. United States Navy Publication

a. Naval Doctrine Publication 1, *Naval Warfare.*

6. United States Marine Corps Publications

a. Marine Corps Doctrinal Publication (MCDP) 1-1, *Strategy.*

b. MCDP 1-2, *Campaigning.*

c. MCDP 1-3, *Tactics.*

d. MCDP 3, *Expeditionary Operations.*

e. MCDP 6, *Command and Control.*

f. *Marine Corps Capabilities Plan.*

7. United States Air Force Publications

a. Air Force Doctrine Publication (AFDP) 1, *The Air Force.*

b. AFDP 2-0, *Intelligence.*

c. AFDP 3-0, *Operations.*

d. AFDP 3-01, *Counterair Operations.*

e. AFDP 3-03, *Counterland Operations.*

f. AFDP 3-05, *Special Operations.*

g. AFDP 3-34, *Engineer Operations.*

h. AFDP 4-0, *Combat Support.*

8. United States Space Force Publication

Space Force Doctrine Document 1, *The Space Force.*

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APPENDIX D
ADMINISTRATIVE INSTRUCTIONS

1. User Comments

Users in the field are highly encouraged to submit comments on this publication using the Joint Doctrine Feedback Form located at: https://jdeis.js.mil/jdeis/jel/jp_feedback_form.pdf and e-mail it to: js.pentagon.j7.mbx.jedd-support@mail.mil. These comments should address content (accuracy, usefulness, consistency, and organization), writing, and appearance.

2. Authorship

The lead agent for this publication is the United States Army. The Joint Staff doctrine sponsor for this publication is the Director for Operations (J-3).

3. Supersession

This publication supersedes JP 3-18, *Joint Forcible Entry Operations,* 11 May 2017, incorporating Change 1, 09 January 2018.

4. Change Recommendations

a. To provide recommendations for urgent and/or routine changes to this publication, please complete the Joint Doctrine Feedback Form located at https://jdeis.js.mil/jdeis/jel/jp_feedback_form.pdf and e-mail it to: js.pentagon.j7.mbx.jedd-support@mail.mil.

b. When a Joint Staff directorate submits a proposal to the CJCS that would change source document information reflected in this publication, that directorate will include a proposed change to this publication as an enclosure to its proposal. The Services and other organizations are requested to notify the Joint Staff J-7 when changes to source documents reflected in this publication are initiated.

5. Lessons Learned

The Joint Lessons Learned Program's (JLLP's) primary objective is to enhance joint force readiness and effectiveness by contributing to improvements in doctrine, organization, training, materiel, leadership and education, personnel, facilities, and policy. The Joint Lessons Learned Information System (JLLIS) is the DoD system of record for lessons learned and facilitates the collection, tracking, management, sharing, collaborative resolution, and dissemination of lessons learned to improve the development and readiness of the joint force. The JLLP integrates with joint doctrine through the joint doctrine development process by providing insights and lessons learned derived from operations, events, and exercises. As these inputs are incorporated into joint doctrine, they become institutionalized for future use, a major goal of the JLLP. Insights and lessons learned are routinely sought and incorporated into draft JPs throughout formal staffing of the development process. The JLLIS Website can be found at https://www.jllis.mil (NIPRNET) or http://www.jllis.smil.mil (SIPRNET).

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b. The Joint Staff does not print hard copies of JPs for distribution. An electronic version of this JP is available on:

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(2) SIPRNET JEL+ at https://jdeis.js.smil.mil/jdeis/index.jsp.

GLOSSARY

PART I—SHORTENED WORD FORMS (ABBREVIATIONS, ACRONYMS, AND INITIALISMS)

A2	antiaccess
AADC	area air defense commander
ACA	airspace control authority
ACS	airspace control system
AD	area denial
AF	amphibious force
AFDP	Air Force doctrine publication
AO	area of operations
AOA	amphibious objective area
AOR	area of responsibility
APOD	aerial port of debarkation
APOE	aerial port of embarkation
APS	Army pre-positioned stocks
ATF	amphibious task force
C2	command and control
CBRN	chemical, biological, radiological, or nuclear
CCDR	combatant commander
CJCSI	Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff instruction
CMO	civil-military operations
COA	course of action
CONOPS	concept of operations
DoD	Department of Defense
EMS	electromagnetic spectrum
HN	host nation
ISB	intermediate staging base
J-2	intelligence directorate of a joint staff
JADO	joint all-domain operations
JFC	joint force commander
JFLCC	joint force land component commander
JFMCC	joint force maritime component commander
JIPOE	joint intelligence preparation of the operational environment
JOA	joint operations area
JP	joint publication
JPP	joint planning process
JSOA	joint special operations area

JTF	joint task force
LF	landing force
LOC	line of communications
LZ	landing zone
MCDP	Marine Corps doctrinal publication
MILDEC	military deception
MPF	maritime pre-positioning force
OA	operational area
OE	operational environment
OIE	operations in the information environment
OPSEC	operations security
ROE	rules of engagement
SOF	special operations forces
SPOD	seaport of debarkation
TF	task force
US	United States
WMD	weapons of mass destruction

PART II—TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

1. JP 3-18, *Joint Forcible Entry Operations,* 20 October 2025, Active Terms and Definitions

air assault. The movement of friendly assault forces by rotary-wing or tiltrotor aircraft to engage and destroy enemy forces or to seize and hold key terrain. (DoD Dictionary. Source: JP 3-18)

airborne assault. The use of airborne forces to parachute into an objective area to attack and eliminate armed resistance and secure designated objectives. (DoD Dictionary. Source: JP 3-18)

airhead. An area that, when seized and held, ensures the continuous air landing of troops and materiel and provides the maneuver space for operations. (Approved for inclusion in the DoD Dictionary.)

airhead line. A line denoting the limits of the objective area for an airborne assault. (DoD Dictionary. Source: JP 3-18)

assault. A short and violent well-ordered attack against a specific objective. (JP 3-18) (Approved for incorporation into the DoD Dictionary.)

forcible entry. Seizing and holding of a military lodgment in the face of armed opposition or forcing access into a denied area to allow movement and maneuver to accomplish the mission. (DoD Dictionary. Source: JP 3-18)

initiating directive. An order to a subordinate commander to conduct military operations as directed. Also called **ID.** (DoD Dictionary. Source: JP 3-18)

lodgment. A designated area in a hostile or potentially hostile operational area that, when seized and held, makes the continuous landing of troops and materiel possible and provides maneuver space for subsequent operations. (DoD Dictionary. Source: JP 3-18)

passage of lines. An operation in which a friendly force moves through another friendly force's combat positions with the intention of moving into or out of contact with the enemy. (Approved for incorporation into the DoD Dictionary.)

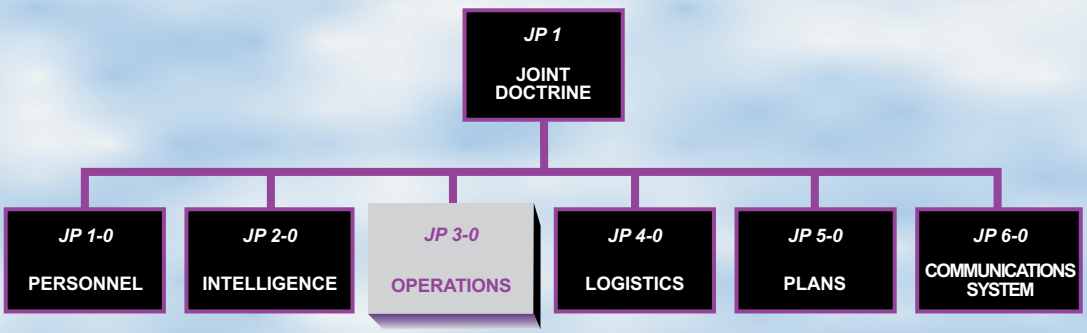
seize. To employ combat forces to occupy physically and to control a designated area. (DoD Dictionary. Source: JP 3-18)

2. Terms Removed from the DoD Dictionary

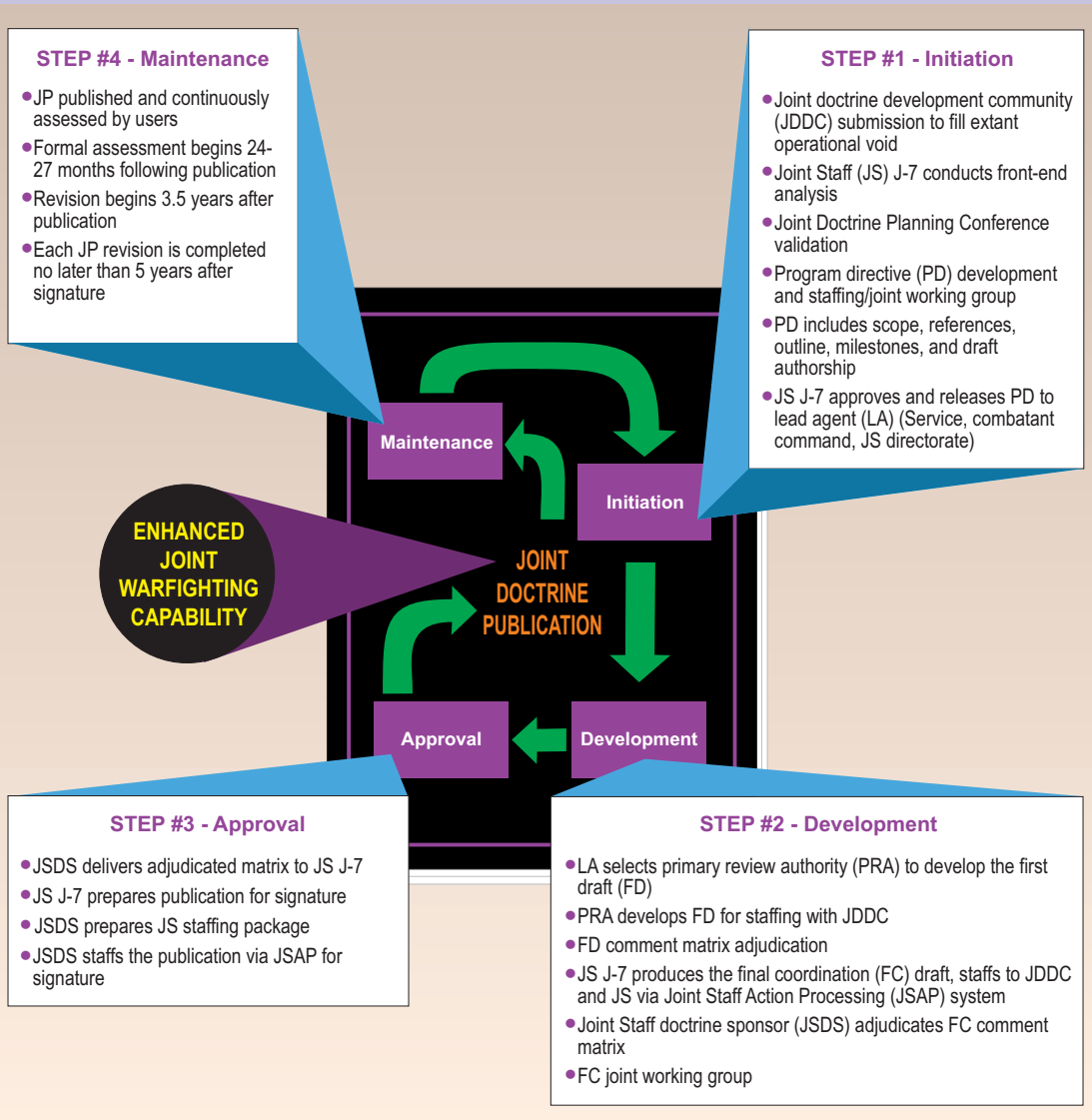
- **Supersession of JP 3-18, *Joint Forcible Entry Operations,* 11 May 2017, incorporating Change 1, 09 January 2018:** air assault force; air assault operation; airborne operation; assault phase; combined arms team; staging base

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JOINT DOCTRINE PUBLICATIONS HIERARCHY



All joint publications are organized into a comprehensive hierarchy as shown in the chart above. **Joint Publication (JP) 3-18** is in the **Operations** series of joint doctrine publications. The diagram below illustrates an overview of the development process:




JOINT
CHIEFS OF STAFF